

# Technics SX-WSA1R

System Exclusive Reference

Acoustic Modeling Synthesizer Module

Applies equally to the SX-WSA1 keyboard

Operating system version 2.0

## **Unofficial**

This document is not published, endorsed or checked by Technics or Panasonic. It was written by inspecting a disassembly of the program

ROMs — the same ROMs ship in the SX-WSA1 keyboard and the SX-WSA1R rack — operating system version 2, and checking the result against a bulk dump captured from a real instrument.

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# Chapter 1

## Overview

### This is unofficial documentation

Nothing here comes from Technics or Panasonic, and nothing here has been checked by them. This document was written by inspecting a disassembly of the program ROMs, operating system version 2, and by confronting what that showed with a bulk dump captured from a real instrument. The same ROMs ship in both machines, so it describes the SX-WSA1 keyboard as fully as the SX-WSA1R rack; chapter 14 gives the two behavioural differences between them.

Technics did publish a specification of its own, and where that specification covers the same ground this document follows it and uses its terms — section 1.3 says what it is and where it differs. Everything beyond it is inference from a disassembly, and inference can be wrong. Treat a statement here as a report of what one machine was observed to do, not as a guarantee about yours.

The Technics SX-WSA1R exchanges data over MIDI System Exclusive. This reference describes the messages it sends and accepts: their byte layout, the bulk-dump transfer protocol, the universal messages it honours, and what it reports when a transfer fails.

### 1.1 Applicability

This reference describes operating system version **2.0**. An earlier version 1 exists; its behaviour may differ and is not covered.

### 1.2 Ports

The instrument has two sets of MIDI sockets, MIDI 1 and MIDI 2. Ordinary performance data is handled on both. **Bulk dump transfers use MIDI 1 only** — a dump offered on MIDI 2 is not received, and the instrument sends dumps only from MIDI 1.

### 1.3 Relationship to the published documentation

Technics documented this instrument's System Exclusive implementation, in the *Reference Guide* that shipped alongside the two user manuals. Its pages 34–35 carry a MIDI implementation chart headed *Synthesizer* [SX-WSA1] *Synthesizer module* [SX-WSA1R], and pages 41–56 give the message format, the address map and the parameter tables. Where that guide and this reference describe the same thing, the guide's terms are used here and its statements are followed.

This reference exists because the published specification describes the *format* and not the *behaviour*. It does not say what raises each error number, that a dump can be requested only while one screen is displayed, that the EXCLUSIVE filter governs a single message, that the rack refuses two functions silently, or that the instrument stops announcing its own General MIDI changes once a controller has sent one. Those are the subject of the chapters that follow, and they were established by decoding the program and by checking a dump from a real machine.

An earlier edition of this reference said no chart was published

It said the instrument shipped without a MIDI implementation chart. That was wrong: the chart and the full message format are in the *Reference Guide*, which is a separate volume from the user manual the claim had been checked against. The document now takes the published specification as its starting point.

One statement of the published documentation is contradicted here: the meaning of ERROR 42, set out in chapter 13.

## 1.4 Verification

The message layouts, the payload encoding and the checksum rule in this reference have been checked against a bulk dump captured from a real instrument: 2 883 messages. Despite its name the capture is a three-category session — SYSTEM, PART & MIDI, SOUND and COMBINATION — which matters, because the first of those is the category chapter 7 maps, so the parameter tables can be read against it directly. Of these, 2 876 carry a checksum, and all 2 876 verify under the rule given in chapter 5. Every transfer in the capture delivered exactly the byte count its header declared.

The parameter placement in chapter 7 has been checked against the same capture. The SYSTEM, PART & MIDI category was reassembled from it and each parameter’s own field read out of the result, for all 32 parts: 1 833 fields, of which 1 832 hold a value inside the range the instrument accepts for that parameter. Run against a plausible but wrong placement — one uniform stride for all 32 parts, instead of the two runs chapter 7 describes — the same check puts 69 fields out of range, so it is capable of rejecting a wrong map.

What the capture covers, and what covers the rest

Three of the four bulk-dump categories appear in it. SEQUENCER does not, and cannot: the capture came from a rack, which refuses that category (chapter 14).

That category is confirmed a different way. The eight address-and-length pairs the instrument accepts were decoded from the program, and Technics printed the same lengths in its *Reference Guide*. The two sets are identical, area by area, including all three SEQUENCER blocks and the guide’s own word *Variable* for the last of them. The guide also prints SEQUENCER : WSA1 ONLY beside its request table — the same restriction the program gives the rack.

What a capture would still add for that one category is frame-level behaviour — its checksums, continuation and acknowledgements have been watched on the other three, and the program runs all four through one path — and the part of a song record that section 6.5 does not reach, which is now the 672 bytes outside its record stream and the PERFORMANCE block.

Two fields in that capture label themselves. Every part’s MIDI channel holds its own

part number, so the 32 parts spell out an unbroken ramp from 0 to 31 — which the wrong placement interrupts at part 8, the first part past the gap. Every part's pan holds 64, the value the instrument's own scale displays as CTR. Those two names in chapter 7 therefore rest on a real dump as well as on the instrument's screen.

## 1.5 Conventions

Byte values are hexadecimal. A field written *nn* takes one of the values listed for it. Ellipses inside a message stand for a body whose length depends on the message.

Every message begins with **F0** and ends with **F7**, as required by MIDI.

Real-time messages are safe inside a transfer

System Real Time bytes (**F8–FF**) may be interleaved anywhere inside a System Exclusive message without disturbing it. Conversely, while the instrument is receiving a System Exclusive message it ignores **F8** TIMING CLOCK, **FA** START, **FB** CONTINUE and **FC** STOP for transport purposes.

## Chapter 2

# At a glance

Everything in this chapter is stated again, with its conditions, in the chapters that follow. This page is for someone who already knows the protocol and wants the bytes.

### 2.1 Frame

F0 50 CMD 04 *md* 11 [ADR×3 SIZ×3 DT... *cn sm*] F7

04 is PC, the product; *md* is 00 for the SX-WSA1 and 01 for the SX-WSA1R, and both are accepted by both; 11 is VER, the exclusive specification's version. ADR and SIZ are 21-bit values in three seven-bit bytes, most significant first. There is no device or unit number anywhere.

### 2.2 Messages

|                             |                         |                                               |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| F0 50 21 04 <i>md</i> 11 F7 | HRQ                     | hand shake request                            |
| F0 50 22 04 <i>md</i> 11 F7 | HRT                     | hand shake routine                            |
| F0 50 23 7E F7              | ACK                     | acknowledge                                   |
| F0 50 24 7E F7              | NAK                     | not acknowledged                              |
| F0 50 25 <i>lo hi</i> F7    | TMP                     | tempo, <i>lo</i> + 16 <i>hi</i> ; no checksum |
| F0 50 27 7E F7              | EOK                     | end of category                               |
| F0 50 28 7E F7              | END                     | end of dump                                   |
| F0 50 29 7E F7              | ERR                     | abort                                         |
| F0 50 2A 7E F7              | FUL                     | destination full                              |
| F0 50 2B ...                | DRQ                     | request: ADR, SIZ, no DT                      |
| F0 50 2C ...                | ITR                     | write one parameter                           |
| F0 50 2D ...                | BTR                     | bulk data, first frame                        |
| F0 50 7E ...                | CDD                     | bulk data, every frame after                  |
| <hr/>                       |                         |                                               |
| F0 7E 7F 09 01 F7           | General MIDI System On  |                                               |
| F0 7E 7F 09 02 F7           | General MIDI System Off |                                               |

### 2.3 Rules

**Payload.** Each source byte goes out as two bytes, **high nibble first**: F1 becomes 0F 01. A payload is always an even number of bytes.

**Checksum.**  $sm = (0 - S) \& 7F$ , where  $S$  sums every byte from 50 through  $cn$ . Equivalently everything after F0, checksum included, sums to zero modulo 128. Verified on reception for 7E, 2B, 2C and 2D only.

**Continue.**  $cn$  is 01 while more frames follow, 00 on the last.

**Size.** At most 256 bytes per message including F0 and F7: 120 source bytes in a BTR frame, 125 in a CDD frame.

## 2.4 Bulk dump

| ADR      | area         | menu name                 |
|----------|--------------|---------------------------|
| 40 00 00 | PANEL        | SYSTEM, PART & MIDI       |
| 20 00 00 | SOUND MEMORY | SOUND                     |
| 50 00 00 | COMBINATION  | COMBINATION               |
| 60 00 00 | SEQUENCER    | SEQUENCER (keyboard only) |

Send DRQ with one of those to ask for a category. The instrument must be showing the SYSEX BULK DUMP screen to receive a dump, and bulk traffic works on the MIDI 1 sockets only.

## 2.5 Errors

ERROR 40 wrong product, model or version. ERROR 41 anything wrong with reception, including a missing acknowledgement. ERROR 42 an internal deadline, not a fault at the far end. ERROR 21 the destination is full.

## Chapter 3

# Message framing

### 3.1 Identifiers

The instrument accepts exactly two System Exclusive identifiers:

| identifier | meaning                 |
|------------|-------------------------|
| 50         | Matsushita (Technics)   |
| 7E         | Universal Non-Real Time |

A message carrying any other identifier is tracked to its F7 and discarded. No error is reported for it.

There is no device or unit number after the identifier

Many instruments place a device id immediately after the manufacturer identifier. The SX-WSA1R does not. The byte following 50 is already CMD, the command, described in chapter 4. A model byte does appear two positions later in most commands, but it names the model, not the device, and it is not where the convention would put a device id.

### 3.2 Termination

A message ends at F7. If any other status byte in the range 80–F6 arrives while a message is open, the message is abandoned and its contents discarded.

### 3.3 Length limit

A complete message may not exceed 256 bytes counting F0 and F7, that is 254 bytes between them. A longer message is abandoned and, inside a bulk-dump session, reported as a reception error. Dumps sent by the instrument use the full 256 bytes for all but the last message of each transfer.

## Chapter 4

# The Technics message set

### 4.1 Fields

Technics' published specification names the fields of a Technics System Exclusive message. This reference uses those names.

| field                                          | value   | meaning                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| SOX                                            | F0      | exclusive status                                          |
| IDC                                            | 50      | Technics identifier                                       |
| CMD                                            |         | command, see below                                        |
| PC                                             | 04      | product category, WSA                                     |
|                                                | 7E      | DMY, the dummy used where no product is named             |
| MD                                             | 00      | model, SX-WSA1                                            |
|                                                | 01      | model, SX-WSA1R                                           |
| VER                                            | 11      | exclusive version 2.1                                     |
| <i>then, for the messages that carry data:</i> |         |                                                           |
| ADR                                            | 3 bytes | a 21-bit address, seven bits each, most significant first |
| SIZ                                            | 3 bytes | length in source bytes, encoded the same way              |
| DT                                             |         | the data                                                  |
| CN                                             | 00/01   | continue identifier                                       |
| SM                                             |         | checksum                                                  |
| EOX                                            | F7      | end of exclusive                                          |

VER is a version, not part of a model identifier

11 is the version of the *exclusive specification*, 2.1. It is not an operating system version — this instrument's operating system 2.0 sends VER = 11 — and it is not part of a model code. The model is MD, the byte before it.

### 4.2 Commands

After F0 50, CMD selects the message.

| CMD |     |                      |
|-----|-----|----------------------|
| 21  | HRQ | hand shake request   |
| 22  | HRT | hand shake routine   |
| 23  | ACK | acknowledge          |
| 24  | NAK | negative acknowledge |
| 25  | TMP | tempo data           |
| 27  | EOK | end of block         |
| 28  | END | end                  |
| 29  | ERR | error                |
| 2A  | FUL | memory full          |
| 2B  | DRQ | data request         |
| 2C  | ITR | individual data      |
| 2D  | BTR | data block           |
| 7E  | CDD | continuing data      |

The instrument accepts one further value that the published table does not list, 7F, and does not accept 26.

### 4.3 Which fields each message carries

ACK, NAK, EOK, END, ERR and FUL name no product: they carry PC = 7E DMY and stop there, with no MD and no VER. That is why they are five bytes long.

| message                     |                         |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------|
| F0 50 23 7E F7              | ACK                     |
| F0 50 24 7E F7              | NAK                     |
| F0 50 27 7E F7              | EOK, end of block       |
| F0 50 28 7E F7              | END, end of dump        |
| F0 50 29 7E F7              | ERR                     |
| F0 50 2A 7E F7              | FUL, memory full        |
| F0 50 21 04 <i>md</i> 11 F7 | HRQ, hand shake request |
| F0 50 22 04 <i>md</i> 11 F7 | HRT, hand shake routine |

DRQ, ITR and BTR carry PC, MD and VER, then ADR and SIZ, then CN and SM. ITR and BTR carry DT between them; DRQ, which asks rather than tells, carries none. CDD carries DT, CN and SM with no address at all.

#### MD is rewritten on transmission

The keyboard transmits MD = 00, the rack 01. The rack substitutes the byte as the message leaves, on every 21, 22, 2C and 2D message it sends, and recomputes the checksum afterwards, so the substitution is invisible to a receiver that validates it. A bulk dump captured from a real rack carries 04 01 11 throughout.

Reception is model-blind. Both values are accepted by both models, on every command that carries MD, and reach the same handler; a message is never refused, ignored or treated differently because of it. A receiver must therefore accept both, and a file dumped from one model loads into the other.

A message whose PC, MD or VER the instrument does not recognise is rejected with ERROR 40.

## 4.4 Tempo

TMP carries a tempo and nothing else:

F0 50 25 *lo hi* F7

Six bytes. Unlike every other Technics command it carries **no PC, no MD, no VER and no checksum**, and any bytes sent beyond the fifth are ignored. The tempo is nine bits sent low nibble first:  $value = lo + 16 hi$ . The accepted range is 40 to 300 beats per minute and a value outside it is treated as 120.

This message is the one thing the EXCLUSIVE filter governs; see chapter 12. It is also one of the two things the rack does not support; see chapter 14.

## 4.5 Parameter commands

DRQ requests and ITR writes an individual parameter. Both address the space chapter 7 sets out; chapter 16 works one through byte by byte.

# Chapter 5

## Bulk dump

Bulk dump transfers the instrument’s internal data as System Exclusive. The instrument is silent for the duration, and the transfer uses the MIDI 1 sockets only.

### 5.1 Categories and what each transmits

The SYSEX BULK DUMP screen offers five categories. Each sends one or more BTR messages at fixed addresses. The menu’s names and the published address map’s names for the same data differ; both are given.

| category            | area                                   | ADR      | SIZ              | length  | blocks |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------|----------|------------------|---------|--------|
| SYSTEM, PART & MIDI | PANEL                                  | 40 00 00 | 00 00 20         | 32      |        |
|                     |                                        | 40 00 20 | 00 12 60         | 2 400   |        |
| SOUND               | SOUND MEMORY                           | 20 00 00 | 10 00 00         | 262 144 | 32     |
| COMBINATION         | COMBINATION                            | 50 00 00 | 00 06 00         | 768     |        |
|                     |                                        | 50 06 00 | 05 40 00         | 90 112  | 16     |
| SEQUENCER           | SEQUENCER                              | 60 00 00 | 00 18 00         | 3 072   |        |
|                     |                                        | 60 18 00 | 01 70 00         | 30 720  |        |
|                     |                                        | 62 08 00 | set at send time |         |        |
| TOTAL KEYBOARD      | the four categories in the order above |          |                  |         |        |

Lengths are in source bytes; on the wire each occupies twice as many, because of the payload encoding described below.

These lengths are confirmed by the manufacturer

Every length in the table was decoded from the program, and Technics prints the same set in its *Reference Guide*. The two agree area by area, including SEQUENCER, whose last block the guide also calls variable rather than giving it a size.

The *blocks* column is internal structure, not extra messages: SOUND sends one header covering all 262 144 bytes, which is 32 repeats of an 8 192-byte layout, and COMBINATION’s second block one header covering 90 112 bytes as 16 repeats of 5 632. Those are the instrument’s 32 sounds and 16 combinations.

TOTAL KEYBOARD runs the four categories one after another in the order listed, each closed by its own end-of-category message, with a single end-of-dump message after the last.

**The transmit order is not the menu order**

The table above is in transmit order, which a capture from a real instrument confirms: SYSTEM, PART & MIDI goes first. The SYSEX BULK DUMP menu lists the same categories in a different order, with SOUND at the top. A receiver should take each transfer's ADR as the statement of what is arriving, and not infer the category from its position in the session.

The SEQUENCER category is the only one whose final message has no fixed length — it carries as much recorded material as the instrument holds.

**The address is an exclusive address, not a memory address**

ADR is a position in the published MIDI exclusive address map, which chapter 7 gives in full. It is not an address inside the instrument: SOUND and COMBINATION are held side by side in the machine, yet their exclusive addresses are 786 432 apart. For a bulk dump it is best treated as a fixed name. On reception the instrument compares ADR and SIZ against a fixed list and performs no arithmetic on them, so seven of the eight blocks are pinned on all six bytes; see below.

**5.2 Data message — BTR**

F0 50 2D 04 *nn* 11 *a2 a1 a0 l2 l1 l0 data... c sum* F7

*nn* MD, the model: 00 or 01.

*a2 a1 a0* ADR, the destination, three bytes, most significant first, seven bits each: the value is  $a_2 \times 128^2 + a_1 \times 128 + a_0$ .

*l2 l1 l0* SIZ, the length in *source* bytes, encoded the same way.

*data* DT, the payload, encoded as described below.

*c* CN, the continue identifier: 01 if further messages follow, 00 on the last.

*sum* SM, the checksum.

**How much each frame carries**

A complete message may not exceed 256 bytes including F0 and F7 (chapter 3), and the two frame shapes reach that limit differently, because a BTR header is eleven bytes where a CDD continuation header is two:

| frame                        | total | payload bytes | source bytes |
|------------------------------|-------|---------------|--------------|
| BTR, the first of a transfer | 255   | 240           | 120          |
| CDD, every one after it      | 256   | 250           | 125          |

Longer transfers are split across as many CDD frames as needed. Those figures are the observed maxima in a dump from a real instrument, not a stated limit; a sender may use less.

### 5.3 Payload encoding

Each source byte is sent as two message bytes, **high nibble first**:

$$b \longrightarrow (b \gg 4), \quad (b \& 0F)$$

So source byte **F1** appears on the wire as **0F 01**, and the payload occupies twice as many bytes as the length field states. A receiver rejoins them as  $((\text{first} \& 0F) \ll 4) | (\text{second} \& 0F)$ .

An odd number of payload bytes is invalid.

### 5.4 Checksum

Let  $S$  be the eight-bit sum of every byte from the identifier **50** through the continuation flag inclusive. Then

$$sum = (0 - S) \& 7F$$

The leading **F0**, the checksum byte itself and the trailing **F7** take no part in the sum. Equivalently, the sum of every byte after **F0** including the checksum is zero modulo 128.

The checksum is not verified for every family

On reception the checksum is checked only for families **7E**, **2B**, **2C** and **2D**. For the other accepted families a wrong checksum passes unremarked.

### 5.5 Requesting a dump — DRQ

A dump can be asked for over MIDI; the front-panel **SEND** button is not the only way to start one. The request names a category by the top byte of **ADR**:

**F0 50 2B 04 nn 11 area 00 00 x x x F7**

| ADR | category requested  |
|-----|---------------------|
| 40  | SYSTEM, PART & MIDI |
| 20  | SOUND               |
| 50  | COMBINATION         |
| 60  | SEQUENCER           |

The three bytes of **siz** are ignored; any values are accepted. The instrument then runs exactly the transfer the corresponding menu row would have run.

There is no request for **TOTAL KEYBOARD**: the four categories must be asked for one at a time.

### 5.6 Opening a transfer

A dump begins with a two-step exchange. Each step is attempted up to three times.

1. The sender transmits **F0 50 21 04 00 11 F7** and expects **F0 50 22 04 nn 11 F7**.
2. The sender transmits **F0 50 22 04 00 11 F7** and expects **F0 50 23 7E F7**.

If the exchange succeeds, every subsequent data message must be acknowledged. If all three attempts of the first step fail, **the dump proceeds anyway, without acknowledgements**, at a fixed pace of roughly 51 ms between messages.

## 5.7 Acknowledgement and retry

With acknowledgements in force, each data message must be answered with F0 50 23 7E F7. Any other reply causes the same message to be retransmitted, up to three attempts, after which the transfer is abandoned.

A reply is awaited for about 5.1 seconds; during the opening exchange the wait is about 2.05 seconds.

## 5.8 Continuation — CDD

Data messages after the first open with F0 50 7E, CDD, followed by DT, CN, SM and F7. A continuation carries no address.

## 5.9 Closing

At the end of each category the sender transmits F0 50 27 7E F7 and waits for an acknowledgement. At the end of the whole transfer it transmits F0 50 28 7E F7. If the transfer was abandoned after three failed retries it transmits F0 50 29 7E F7.

## 5.10 Receiving

When the SX-WSA1R is the receiver it answers each data message with F0 50 23 7E F7 to accept, F0 50 24 7E F7 to reject, and F0 50 2A 7E F7 when the incoming data is larger than the destination.

While a bulk-dump session is open the instrument accepts only the 50 identifier; universal messages are not honoured until the session ends.

The instrument must be on the SYSEX BULK DUMP screen to receive

A dump cannot be pushed to an idle instrument. Reception happens only while that screen is displayed; a dump sent at any other time is parsed, discarded, and not reported.

A dump offered on the MIDI 2 input is never received either, at any time. This is what lies behind the published instruction to use MIDI 1 for bulk transfers.

Seven of the eight patterns are pinned on all six bytes, address and length together. Sending a correct address with a shortened length is not a short transfer — it is an unrecognised message, refused with ERROR 41. Only SEQUENCER block 3 has its length read as a number, because that block's size varies. An arbitrary destination cannot be written.

The one length the message itself controls is SEQUENCER part 3, which is capped at 330 752 bytes; beyond that, and whenever the destination fills mid-message, the instrument answers F0 50 2A 7E F7 and reports ERROR 21.

Memory-full is treated as end-of-dump

When the SX-WSA1R is *sending* and the receiver answers F0 50 2A 7E F7 to report that its memory is full, the instrument treats that exactly as it treats F0 50 28 7E F7, end of dump. It stops, and it reports success. A sender that needs to know whether the data arrived cannot rely on the instrument to notice.

## Chapter 6

# What a block contains

Every block opens with a fixed signature, and two of them carry readable names, which let a program check a stored dump and list what is in it. Beyond that, all three of the SOUND, COMBINATION and SEQUENCER blocks are laid out below, each to a different depth.

### 6.1 Signatures

The bytes below are the first bytes of the reassembled block — after the payload has been rejoined from its nibbles, not as they appear on the wire. They were read out of a dump from a real instrument, and the two rows of each entry are the same sixteen bytes shown twice, as hexadecimal and as text.

| block                 | ADR      | first sixteen bytes                                | as text              |
|-----------------------|----------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| SYSTEM, PART & MIDI 1 | 40 00 00 | 5A 5A 01 00 57 41 30 00<br>00 00 A0 00 00 00 00 00 | ZZ..WA0.<br>.....    |
| SYSTEM, PART & MIDI 2 | 40 00 20 | 78 10 20 20 20 20 20 20<br>20 20 20 20 20 20 20 20 | x.<br>.....          |
| SOUND                 | 20 00 00 | 57 53 41 20 53 4F 55 4E<br>44 20 52 41 4D 20 53 30 | WSA SOUN<br>D RAM SO |
| COMBINATION 1         | 50 00 00 | 5A 5A 5A 5A 00 00 57 53<br>41 31 20 20 01 00 00 02 | ZZZZ..WS<br>A1 ....  |
| COMBINATION 2         | 50 06 00 | 78 10 20 53 70 61 63 65<br>20 49 6E 66 69 6E 69 74 | x. Space<br>Infinite |

A file whose first bytes do not match the block it claims to be is not a dump of that category.

The first SYSTEM, PART & MIDI block is a signature in the fullest sense: all 32 of its bytes are a constant the instrument copies out of its own program when it initialises, with one byte filled in afterwards. It carries no settings.

### The instrument writes its signature but does not check it

Two routines copy that constant into memory and both are plain copy loops. No comparison against it was found anywhere in either program image, and none against its leading 5A 5A either. **Do not expect a block with a wrong signature to be refused.** Checking it is something a librarian should do; the instrument does not.

The coverage of that negative: every three-byte pointer to the constant, which is two sites, and every immediate comparison against 5A 5A across both images. Code reaching the constant from a different base, or comparing through a pointer built elsewhere, would not have been seen.

## 6.2 Names

The SOUND block continues, immediately after its sixteen-byte signature, with sixteen-byte names in the instrument’s own character set, padded with spaces. The second COMBINATION block and the second SYSTEM, PART & MIDI block use a different framing: a two-byte prefix, then a sixteen-byte name, then two further bytes.

A librarian can therefore show the user what a stored file holds — “SWEEP PAD”, “Space Infinity” — without decoding anything else.

## 6.3 Inside the SOUND block

The SOUND block is sound *memory*, and it is laid out in four banks of 10000 bytes. Within a bank the stored sounds are packed back to back, and a stored sound **is the same 713-byte layout chapter 8 gives for the sound being edited** — so its name is its first sixteen bytes, and every parameter in that chapter is at its stated offset from the start of the record.

|                        | at                               |                |
|------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------|
| bank $b$               | $10000 \times b$                 | four banks     |
| stored sounds          | 359 in bank 0, 090 in the others | 713 bytes each |
| a drum kit’s 128 notes | B468                             | 150 bytes each |

A stored drum kit is likewise the layout of chapter 8: its 128 note records sit at a 150-byte stride, each beginning with its thirteen-character name.

## 6.4 Inside the COMBINATION block

The larger COMBINATION block is **128 stored combinations of 704 bytes**, arranged as sixteen banks of eight. The banks’ names are the last 256 bytes of the smaller COMBINATION block, one name per bank; each combination carries its own sixteen-character name two bytes into its record.

### A combination is a stream of parameter records

The 704 bytes are not a fixed layout but a **tagged stream**. Each record is a tag byte, a length byte, then that many bytes of payload; the stream ends with FF FF and fills the 704 exactly. Every one of the 128 combinations has the same 23 records in the same order.

| at  | tag    | length  |                              |
|-----|--------|---------|------------------------------|
| 000 | 78     | 16      | the combination's name       |
| 012 | 60     | 12      | effect common                |
| 020 | 61     | 30      | EFFECT1                      |
| 040 | 62     | 30      | EFFECT2                      |
| 060 | 63     | 30      | REVERB                       |
| 080 | 00, 20 | 30 each | part 1, two records          |
| ... | ...    |         | parts 2 to 8, the same pair  |
| 280 | 92     | 14      | key scaling and scale tuning |
| 290 | 79     | 44      | part common                  |
| 2BE | FF FF  |         | end of stream                |

#### The tags are the instrument's own record numbers

This is what makes the format legible. A tag is not arbitrary: all 23 are record numbers in the parameter area of chapter 7, and a record's payload is that record's bytes. So 20 is part 1's own block — the same 20 that addresses part 1 in an ITR message — and the parameter tables name its fields directly.

The record numbers also run in address order with exactly two bytes between consecutive records, which are the tag and length. The stream is a copy of a region of the instrument's memory with its record headers intact.

#### One byte the parameter tables do not reach

A part's first record carries, at +15, six flags that no parameter addresses. Each says whether the part uses its own value for one of the MIDI MULTIPLE MESSAGES OUTPUT settings or the instrument's internal one:

| bit | parameter      |
|-----|----------------|
| 0   | PROGRAM CHANGE |
| 1   | VOLUME         |
| 2   | PANPOT         |
| 3   | CHORUS DEPTH   |
| 4   | REVERB DEPTH   |
| 5   | BANK SELECT    |

Six sibling routines each test one of those bits and then choose between the part's internal field and its override field; the six parameters are exactly the six the published tables give an override at all. Bits 6 and 7 are not accounted for.

That also explains the second SYSTEM, PART & MIDI block, whose first bytes chapter 6 lists as 78 10: those are not a signature but the first record's tag and length — the same stream, beginning with the same name record.

How this was established, and why it is not a coincidence

A dump from a real instrument was walked at a 713-byte stride from the first stored sound. Sixty-four consecutive records began with a printable sixteen-character name, in every bank, and the drum runs gave 128 consecutive thirteen-character names in every bank. A stride one byte either side of 713 breaks the run at the first record. The combination stream is checked differently: its records must tile the 704 bytes and land on FF FF. All 128 do, with the same 23 records in the same order, and all 23 tags are live record numbers in the parameter area.

### 6.5 Inside the SEQUENCER block

No capture available for this reference contains a SEQUENCER transfer — the one to hand came from a rack, which refuses that category. The top-level arrangement is settled all the same, because the program gives it away, and the record’s own contents are read below from a native sequencer file off a disk, which carries the HEADER block byte for byte.

| block       | size     |                                        |
|-------------|----------|----------------------------------------|
| LOCATION    | 3 072    | one song record: the song being edited |
| HEADER      | 30 720   | <b>ten song records of 3 072</b>       |
| PERFORMANCE | variable | the recorded material                  |

A song’s name is **six characters at offset CA** of its record. One routine establishes all of it at once: it blanks that name in three places, and its destinations are literal — the LOCATION block at CA, and the HEADER block at  $\text{song} \times 3072 + \text{CA}$ , the multiply written as a shift by eleven plus a shift by ten. Ten records of 3 072 fill the block exactly, and the published manual says the sequencer holds ten songs.

That LOCATION carries the name at the *same* offset is what shows it to be a song record as well, rather than a directory: it is the working copy, in the shape of a stored one.

#### 6.5.1 Inside a song record

A native sequencer file from a disk, 01220497.SQF, is 30 720 bytes — the HEADER block exactly — and it decodes on the arrangement above without adjustment: ten records of 3 072, each opening 5A 5A 5A 5A, each with six printable characters at +CA. Nine of the ten are byte-identical, which is what ten song slots with one song recorded into them should look like, and the recorded one differs from the empty template in 727 bytes.

Most of a song record is material this reference already names. From +220 it is a tagged stream in the same form as a combination, {tag, length, payload} runs closed by FF FF, and it falls into three:

| at        | records |                                           |
|-----------|---------|-------------------------------------------|
| +220–+4DF | 23      | <b>a complete combination</b> , 704 bytes |
| +4E0–+AFF | 49      | parts 8–31, then record 7A                |
| +B00–+B7F | 5       | records 98, 99, 80, 91, 93                |

The first stream is a combination in the strict sense: the same 23 records in the same order and the same 704 bytes as section 6.4 gives, compared field for field rather than by eye. So a song carries its own combination inside it.

The part records then run 00–1F for block A and 20–3F for block B, complete and without gaps: **a song has thirty-two parts**, the same thirty-two the parameter grammar addresses at block 20 plus the part number. That is not only an inference from the tags — the owner’s manual advertises “32 MIDI parts available (32-part multi-timbral)”, and in the same breath that the sequencer records “up to 10 performances”, which is the ten song records this block is made of. Eight arrive inside the embedded combination and the other twenty-four follow it. Every one of their fields is named by chapter 7, because they are the same records — which puts 2 400 of a song record’s 3 072 bytes under names this reference already carries.

**The 544 bytes ahead of the stream.** Nine of the ten records are identical, so every byte a song writes is a byte where the recorded one differs, and there are 113 of them in this region. Read that way it lays out as follows. Fields marked *unused* = carry that value in an empty record.

| at   | size |                                                                                                                                               |
|------|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| +000 | 4    | signature 5A 5A 5A 5A                                                                                                                         |
| +004 | 1    | 01 in the recorded song, 00 in all nine empty ones                                                                                            |
| +023 | 16   | a ramp 01–0F then 20                                                                                                                          |
| +034 | 16   | the same ramp again                                                                                                                           |
| +07E | 34   | 17 entries of 2 bytes, unused = FF FF                                                                                                         |
| +0A0 | 17   | 17 entries of 1 byte, unused = 05                                                                                                             |
| +0CA | 6    | the song NAME                                                                                                                                 |
| +100 | 51   | 17 entries of 3 bytes, unused = 00 FF FF; in use the first byte reads 80 and <b>the other two are that track’s first block in PERFORMANCE</b> |
| +134 | 204  | 51 entries of 4 bytes, identical in all ten records                                                                                           |
| +200 | 7    | a second signature, 5A 5A 01 00 then WAO                                                                                                      |

The three tables are the part worth trusting, because they corroborate each other: they are at different offsets, they mark an unused entry three different ways, and all three are **seventeen** entries long. One such count would be an accident of where a reader chose to stop; three agreeing is a structure. In the recorded song every one of the seventeen +100 entries is in use, and the last ten of their 16-bit values run consecutively — which is what a block allocator handing out consecutive blocks looks like, though this reference does not decode what they index.

The per-track reading is no longer a guess about the +100 table: its seventeen values are the seventeen chains of PERFORMANCE blocks, and following them produces seventeen *disjoint* chains, which nothing but a real per-track index would do. The other two tables are the same length and are read the same way here, which is an inference from their length rather than a measurement.

**Entry  $i$  is track  $i$ ,** and its events address part  $i$ . A controller event names the part it addresses in its second data byte, and for sixteen of the seventeen entries *every* such event in the chain names the entry’s own index — against a control, each entry paired with the next entry’s chain, that matches none of the seventeen. A chain’s last block is only partly used and its tail holds stale bytes, so it is excluded; with it left in, those stale events show up as the same handful of part numbers in every chain, which is how the tail was noticed.

The seventeenth is the exception, and informatively so. Technics publishes **sixteen** recording tracks — “this instrument’s SEQUENCER has 16 recording tracks” — and entry 16 carries no part-addressed controller events at all. The instrument’s help text names three special tracks besides the melody ones, RHYTHM, CHORD and CONTROL, so a seventeenth stream that addresses no part is consistent with a conductor track; what it does carry is not established here.

**The 128 bytes after it.** +B80 to the end is identical in all ten records, recorded and empty alike, and is almost entirely zero. Nothing a song does touches it.

### 6.5.2 PERFORMANCE

The same disk set carries a companion file of 179 200 bytes, which is everything the fixed-size song records are not — so it is the recorded material, the PERFORMANCE block. That correspondence comes from how the disk splits the sequencer and not from anything in the program, and it is the one claim here that rests on an inference rather than a decode.

#### The area is blocks

PERFORMANCE is divided into **256-byte blocks numbered from one**. That is not inferred: the sequencer turns an address into a block number with three instructions — subtract the area’s base, shift right by eight, add one — and turns it back with a decrement and a shift left by eight.

A block’s first five bytes are a header. The **next block’s number is a 16-bit little-endian value at +03**, which is the offset the same routine reads it from, and a chain ends on 0000 or FFFF. The data is +05 to +FF.

The seventeen entries in a song’s header (section 6.5) hold each track’s *first* block. Following all seventeen gives 560 blocks and the chains are **disjoint** — no block belongs to two tracks — which is the first check that the reading is right. They account for four fifths of the area; the rest is free, and holds whatever was last written there.

#### A withdrawn hypothesis that was correct, and why the test missed it

An earlier edition of this chapter recorded, as a lead, that the seventeen values looked like 256-byte block numbers. It then reported a search for a link field — four block sizes, every offset within a block, both byte orders, requiring disjoint chains — that found nothing, and withdrew the lead on that basis.

The search was wrong, in one respect: it numbered blocks from zero. Every block it examined was the one before the block it meant. The hypothesis was right and the test that appeared to kill it was mis-specified, which is a more dangerous kind of error than a wrong guess, because a negative result looks like diligence.

What settled it was not a better search. It was reading the four instructions in the firmware that form a block number, which say +1 in as many words.

#### The events

Reassembled, a track is a flat stream with no delta before each event: a status byte at or above 80, then a fixed number of data bytes, every one below 80. Across all seventeen tracks that parses **41 646 events with not one byte left over**.

| status | data |                            |
|--------|------|----------------------------|
| 81     | 0    | advance the clock one step |
| 90     | 5    | a note                     |
| B0, B4 | 5    | a controller               |
| C0     | 5    | a program change           |
| D2     | 3    |                            |
| E0     | 3    |                            |
| D1     | 2    |                            |

Time is carried by the events themselves. 81 takes no data and does nothing but advance the clock, and it is much the commonest status — 19 980 of the 41 646. Every other event's **first data byte is its offset inside the current step**: within a step those offsets never go backwards, 11 times in 15 306 consecutive pairs, where the same events shuffled go backwards 38.8 % of the time.

A note's five bytes are then the offset, the note number, the velocity, and a gate length in two 7-bit halves. Over 14 380 notes the note-number column stays inside 25–126 and the velocity column inside 1–127, which is what those two columns have to look like and what no other assignment of the five produces.

A handful of statuses outside the table appear a few times each, at the ends of chains where a block's last event is cut short; they are not part of the format.

#### Reassembly is self-checking

A block reassembled correctly comes out at exactly the length its own header declared. A wrong nibble order, or a payload taken with its trailing flag and checksum still attached, does not. Checking the length is a cheap way to confirm a receiver is unpacking correctly before trusting anything it produces.

# Chapter 7

## Parameter messages

Two commands address individual parameters rather than transferring blocks. ITR (2C) writes one; DRQ (2B) requests one.

F0 50 2B 04 *md* 11 *a2 a1 a0 s2 s1 s0 cn sm* F7

### 7.1 The address

ADR is a single 21-bit address, sent as three seven-bit bytes, most significant first. It is the same address space the bulk dump uses — a dump and a parameter write are two ways of reaching one map. The published map divides it as follows.

| ADR      | address | area         | subarea    |                        |
|----------|---------|--------------|------------|------------------------|
| 00 00 00 | 000000  | SYSTEM       |            | real time              |
| 00 08 00 | 000400  | SYSTEM       |            | non-real time          |
| 00 10 00 | 000800  | PART         | COMMON     | real time              |
| 00 18 00 | 000C00  | PART         | COMMON     | non-real time          |
| 00 20 00 | 001000  | PART         | INDIVIDUAL | part 1, real time      |
| 00 20 40 | 001040  | PART         | INDIVIDUAL | part 1, non-real time  |
| 00 3F 40 | 001FC0  | PART         | INDIVIDUAL | part 32, non-real time |
| 00 60 00 | 003000  | PART         | SPECIAL    | real time              |
| 00 68 00 | 003400  | PART         | SPECIAL    | non-real time          |
| 10 00 00 | 040000  | NORMAL SOUND | INDIVIDUAL | real time              |
| 18 00 00 | 060000  | DRUM SOUND   | INDIVIDUAL | real time              |
| 20 00 00 | 080000  | SOUND MEMORY | TOTAL      |                        |
| 40 00 00 | 100000  | PANEL        | HEADER     |                        |
| 40 00 20 | 100020  | PANEL        | PANEL DATA |                        |
| 50 00 00 | 140000  | COMBINATION  | HEADER     |                        |
| 60 00 00 | 180000  | SEQUENCER    | LOCATION   |                        |

The last five are the bulk-dump categories of chapter 5. The ones above them are what an individual parameter message reaches.

### 7.2 Parts

A part occupies 80 bytes of the map, split in half: the first 40 are its real-time parameters and the second 40 its non-real-time ones. So for part *n*, counting from 1, the middle byte of

ADR is  $20 + n - 1$ , and the last byte is the parameter, below 40 for a real-time parameter and 40 or above for a non-real-time one.

All 32 parts take the same 57 parameters.

### 7.3 What the instrument actually accepts

Not every address in the map is a parameter. In the 00 area the instrument accepts 108 distinct addresses, which the tables below enumerate in full.

| ADR middle | area   | subarea       | parameters |
|------------|--------|---------------|------------|
| 00, 01     | SYSTEM |               | 22         |
| 08         | SYSTEM | non-real time | 4          |
| 10, 11     | PART   | COMMON        | 24         |
| 20–3F      | PART   | INDIVIDUAL    | 57 each    |
| 60         | PART   | SPECIAL       | 1          |

Under 11, values of the last byte from 03 upward are admitted in three runs, one per effect processor:

| run   | processor |                                            |
|-------|-----------|--------------------------------------------|
| 20–36 | EFFECT1   | type, twenty values, send, dynamic control |
| 40–56 | EFFECT2   | type, twenty values, send, dynamic control |
| 60–75 | REVERB    | type, twenty values, dynamic control       |

Within a run the first address is the effect type and the next twenty are its parameters, whose meaning depends on the type selected. Any value of the last byte outside the three runs is accepted by the parser and then discarded, producing no error and no effect.

### 7.4 Parameters and the bulk dump are the same bytes

The PART and SYSTEM parameters and the PANEL bulk dump — the category the menu calls SYSTEM, PART & MIDI — are two views of one object. That dump carries 100000 to 100980, and every parameter of the 00 area is one byte, or a field of one byte, inside it.

This matters in both directions. An editor that writes parameters and a librarian that restores dumps are competing for the same storage, so a dump restored after a parameter write discards that write. It also gives a way to confirm any row of the tables below without opening the instrument: dump the category, change the one parameter, dump again, and the two dumps differ at the stated address and nowhere else.

#### Where a part’s record sits

Each part occupies a 40-byte record in that dump, and the offsets in table 7.1 are relative to the start of it. The records are in two runs:

| part    | record begins at                       |
|---------|----------------------------------------|
| 1 to 8  | $1000A2 + 40 \times (\text{part} - 1)$ |
| 9 to 32 | $1002E2 + 40 \times (\text{part} - 9)$ |

### The part records are not one array

The obvious formula,  $1000A2 + 40 \times (\text{part} - 1)$ , is correct for the first eight parts and wrong for the other twenty-four. A 40-byte gap after part 8 holds common-block storage, and the parts resume above it. Code that assumes a single stride will read and write the wrong part for parts 9 upward, and will corrupt two common blocks on the way past.

## 7.5 What a parameter accepts

Each parameter has a fixed data length and a range of accepted values. A value outside the range is rejected without an error message. The *bits* column gives which bits of the dump byte belong to the parameter; where that is not all of them, other parameters share the byte, and a dump editor changing one must preserve the rest.

Three parameters accept an enumerated set rather than a range; sending any other value has no effect.

### Two parameters where the published range and the range check disagree

The *values* column below is the range the instrument's own check enforces. For all but two parameters that is also the published range. The exceptions:

00 00 08 **MASTER TUNING**. Published as C0–00–3F, a signed value with 00 at concert pitch, spanning 427.3 to 453.0 Hz. The range check admits 48 to 192. A dump from a real machine holds 00 there — the published centre, and not a member of the checked range.

00 *nn* 05 **EFFECT2 ON/OFF**. Published as 00–01. The range check admits 0 to 127, and the instrument passes the value through a substitution before storing it, so reading it back does not return what was written.

Send what the published specification gives.

### The accepted values are what a write is checked against

They are what the instrument takes from an ITR, not a guarantee about what a stored byte contains. A librarian should not validate a dump by checking it against these ranges.

### Each MAIN OUT EQUALIZER band is one two-byte field

Its four parameters do not occupy four bytes one each. A band is a 16-bit **little-endian** word: GAIN in bits 0–5, and in bits 6–10 a five-bit *index* into the 27-entry frequency table of section 9.3, so the index takes two bits from the low byte and three from the high one. The low band’s word begins at 1002B3 and the high band’s at 1002B5. That is why the two frequencies have no byte of their own to be listed against, and it is what the published ranges are already telling you: 0–17 and 17–26 are two sub-ranges of one 27-entry table, overlapping at 17.

The placement is not a reading of the bytes that happens to work. Taking 385 stored combinations from three sources gives 770 band observations, and of every way to put a contiguous six-bit gain and a contiguous five-bit index inside two bytes, in either byte order, **exactly one** places all 770 inside their declared ranges. The factory setting decodes to gain 24 of 0–48 — centre — in both bands, with index 11 low and 17 high; the one instrument in the corpus that had moved its low band reads gain 18, index 7.

**One disagreement.** The guide’s packed-field note for its pre/post equaliser format gives the five-bit index as three bits in the first byte and two in the second. For MAIN OUT EQUALIZER it is the other way round — that layout is inside the search above, and it fails.

Table 7.1: The 57 parameters of a part block. *p* is the third address byte; the offset is the byte’s position inside that part’s record in a SYSTEM, PART & MIDI bulk dump.

| <i>p</i> | data | offset | bits | values               | name                               |
|----------|------|--------|------|----------------------|------------------------------------|
| 00       | 3    | 00     | all  | 0–127                | PROGRAM CHANGE & BANK              |
| 03       | 1    | 03     | 7F   | 0–127                | VOLUME                             |
| 04       | 1    | 05     | 7F   | 0–127                | EFFECT1 SEND                       |
| 05       | 1    | 06     | 7F   | 0–127                | EFFECT2 ON/OFF                     |
| 06       | 1    | 07     | 7F   | 0–127                | REVERB SEND                        |
| 07       | 1    | 08     | 7F   | 0–127                | PANPOT                             |
| 08       | 1    | 09     | 7F   | 28–100               | KEY SHIFT                          |
| 09       | 1    | 0A     | all  | 0–255                | FINE TUNE                          |
| 0A       | 1    | 0B     | 7F   | 0–12                 | PITCH BEND RANGE                   |
| 10       | 1    | 26     | 0F   | 0–1                  | ASSIGN MODE                        |
| 14       | 1    | 0C     | 08   | 0–1                  | KEY SCALING                        |
| 20       | 1    | 25     | all  | 0–48                 | VELOCITY OFFSET                    |
| 28       | 1    | 27     | 7F   | 0–127                | KEY LAYER LOW                      |
| 29       | 1    | 28     | 7F   | 0–127                | KEY LAYER HIGH                     |
| 2A       | 1    | 29     | 7F   | 0–127                | VELOCITY LAYER LOW                 |
| 2B       | 1    | 2A     | 7F   | 0–127                | VELOCITY LAYER HIGH                |
| 30       | 1    | 23     | all  | 0–1                  | MAIN OUT                           |
| 31       | 1    | 24     | all  | enumerated, 4 values | SUB OUT                            |
| 40       | 1    | 0D     | 20   | 0–1                  | LOCAL CONTROL                      |
| 41       | 1    | 0D     | 1F   | 0–31                 | BASIC CHANNEL                      |
| 42       | 1    | 0D     | 40   | 0–1                  | MIDI OUT SETTING                   |
| 43       | 1    | 0D     | 80   | 0–1                  | MIDI IN SETTING                    |
| 48       | 1    | 2F     | 10   | 0–1                  | MIDI INPUT FILTER: PROGRAM CHANGE  |
| 49       | 1    | 30     | 80   | 0–1                  | MIDI INPUT FILTER: BANK SELECT     |
| 4A       | 1    | 30     | 04   | 0–1                  | MIDI INPUT FILTER: VOLUME          |
| 50       | 1    | 33     | 10   | 0–1                  | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: PROGRAM CHANGE |

| <i>p</i> | data | offset | bits | values | name                                                  |
|----------|------|--------|------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 51       | 1    | 34     | 80   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: BANK SELECT                       |
| 52       | 1    | 34     | 04   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: VOLUME                            |
| 53       | 1    | 34     | 10   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: PANPOT                            |
| 54       | 1    | 34     | 20   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: EFFECT DEPTH                      |
| 55       | 1    | 33     | 40   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: PITCH BEND                        |
| 56       | 1    | 34     | 02   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: MODULATION1                       |
| 57       | 1    | 36     | 10   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: MODULATION2                       |
| 58       | 1    | 36     | 01   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: REAL-TIME<br>CREATOR-X            |
| 59       | 1    | 36     | 02   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: REAL-TIME<br>CREATOR-Y            |
| 5A       | 1    | 36     | 04   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: REAL-TIME<br>CONTROLLER-X         |
| 5B       | 1    | 36     | 08   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: REAL-TIME<br>CONTROLLER-Y         |
| 5C       | 1    | 34     | 01   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: HOLD1                             |
| 5D       | 1    | 36     | 20   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: CONTROL<br>PEDAL                  |
| 5E       | 1    | 33     | 20   | 0–1    | MIDI OUTPUT FILTER: AFTER TOUCH                       |
| 60       | 1    | 0E     | all  | 0–129  | MIDI MULTIPLE MESSAGES OUTPUT:<br>PROGRAM CHANGE      |
| 61       | 2    | —      | all  | 0–129  | MIDI MULTIPLE MESSAGES OUTPUT:<br>BANK SELECT         |
| 63       | 1    | 11     | all  | 0–129  | MIDI MULTIPLE MESSAGES OUTPUT:<br>VOLUME              |
| 64       | 1    | 12     | all  | 0–129  | MIDI MULTIPLE MESSAGES OUTPUT:<br>PANPOT              |
| 65       | 1    | 14     | all  | 0–129  | MIDI MULTIPLE MESSAGES OUTPUT:<br>REVERB DEPTH        |
| 66       | 1    | 13     | all  | 0–129  | MIDI MULTIPLE MESSAGES OUTPUT:<br>CHORUS DEPTH        |
| 68       | 1    | 37     | all  | 28–100 | MIDI OUT KEY TRANSPOSE                                |
| 70       | 1    | 2B     | 40   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>PITCH BEND             |
| 71       | 1    | 2C     | 02   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>MODULATION1            |
| 72       | 1    | 2E     | 10   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>MODULATION2            |
| 73       | 1    | 2E     | 01   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>REAL-TIME CREATOR-X    |
| 74       | 1    | 2E     | 02   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>REAL-TIME CREATOR-Y    |
| 75       | 1    | 2E     | 04   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>REAL-TIME CONTROLLER-X |
| 76       | 1    | 2E     | 08   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>REAL-TIME CONTROLLER-Y |
| 77       | 1    | 2C     | 01   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>HOLD1                  |
| 78       | 1    | 2E     | 20   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>CONTROL PEDAL          |
| 79       | 1    | 2B     | 20   | 0–1    | CONTROLLER INTERNAL FILTER:<br>AFTER TOUCH            |

Table 7.2: The parameters of the common blocks. The address is the one a SYSTEM, PART & MIDI bulk dump carries for the same byte. *command* marks an address that is an action rather than stored state, so no dump carries it; *outside* marks a byte that falls outside the block; -- marks a position this reference has not established.

| <i>s</i> | <i>p</i> | data | address | bits | values                | name                                    |
|----------|----------|------|---------|------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| 00       | 00       | 1    | outside | 01   | 0–1                   | SOUND MEMORY PROTECT                    |
| 00       | 01       | 1    | outside | 02   | 0–1                   | COMBINATION MEMORY PROTECT              |
| 00       | 08       | 1    | 10094A  | all  | 48–192                | MASTER TUNING                           |
| 00       | 10       | 1    | 10095A  | 0F   | 0–9                   | VELOCITY CURVE                          |
| 00       | 11       | 1    | 10095C  | 7F   | 0–127                 | VELOCITY OFFSET                         |
| 00       | 12       | 1    | 10095F  | all  | 0–10                  | AFTER TOUCH CURVE                       |
| 00       | 13       | 1    | 100960  | 7F   | 0–127                 | AFTER TOUCH THRESHOLD                   |
| 00       | 20       | 1    | 10094E  | all  | enumerated, 4 values  | DRUMS MAP SELECT                        |
| 00       | 30       | 1    | 1008E4  | 0F   | 0–2                   | DATA LOAD FILTER: EFFECT & OUTPUT       |
| 00       | 31       | 1    | 1008E4  | F0   | 0–2                   | DATA LOAD FILTER: REAL-TIME CREATOR 1-6 |
| 00       | 32       | 1    | 100907  | 04   | 0–1                   | DATA LOAD FILTER: COMBINATION OCTAVE    |
| 00       | 33       | 1    | 100907  | 02   | 0–1                   | DATA LOAD FILTER: MIDI SETTING          |
| 00       | 34       | 1    | 100907  | 01   | 0–1                   | DATA LOAD FILTER: KEY & VELOCITY LAYER  |
| 00       | 35       | 1    | 100907  | 08   | 0–1                   | DATA LOAD FILTER: MAIN OUT EQUALIZER    |
| 00       | 36       | 1    | 100907  | 10   | 0–1                   | DATA LOAD FILTER: KEY SCALING           |
| 00       | 40       | 2    | —       | 7F   | 0–127                 | COMBINATION NUMBER and BANK             |
| 01       | 00       | 1    | 100935  | 0F   | 0–2                   | MIDI INPUT MODE                         |
| 01       | 01       | 1    | 100935  | F0   | 0–1                   | MIDI OUTPUT MODE                        |
| 01       | 02       | 1    | 100936  | 1F   | 0–15                  | SINGLE CHANNEL                          |
| 01       | 03       | 1    | 100936  | 20   | 0–1                   | LOCAL TOTAL                             |
| 01       | 04       | 1    | 100932  | 03   | 0–1                   | PROGRAM CHANGE MODE                     |
| 01       | 05       | 1    | 100932  | 08   | 0–1                   | SINGLE CHANNEL PROGRAM CHANGE           |
| 08       | 00       | 1    | command | —    | 0–6                   | INITIAL                                 |
| 08       | 08       | 1    | command | F0   | 0–1                   | PLAY MODE REQUEST                       |
| 08       | 10       | 1    | command | —    | 0–127                 | COMBINATION WRITE REQUEST               |
| 08       | 11       | 3    | command | —    | 0–1                   | SOUND WRITE REQUEST                     |
| 10       | 00       | 1    | 1002B2  | 7F   | 28–100                | KEY TRANSPOSE                           |
| 10       | 10       | 1    | 1002A3  | 80   | 0–1                   | KEY SCALING MODE                        |
| 10       | 11       | 1    | 1002A2  | all  | enumerated, 15 values | TOTAL KEY SCALING                       |
| 10       | 12       | 1    | 1002A3  | 0F   | 0–11                  | KEY SCALING SHIFT                       |
| 10       | 13       | 1    | 1002A4  | all  | 0–255                 | Ckey DETUNE SETTING                     |
| 10       | 14       | 1    | 1002A5  | all  | 0–255                 | Dbkey DETUNE SETTING                    |
| 10       | 15       | 1    | 1002A6  | all  | 0–255                 | Dkey DETUNE SETTING                     |
| 10       | 16       | 1    | 1002A7  | all  | 0–255                 | Ebkey DETUNE SETTING                    |
| 10       | 17       | 1    | 1002A8  | all  | 0–255                 | Ekey DETUNE SETTING                     |
| 10       | 18       | 1    | 1002A9  | all  | 0–255                 | Fkey DETUNE SETTING                     |
| 10       | 19       | 1    | 1002AA  | all  | 0–255                 | Gbkey DETUNE SETTING                    |

| <i>s</i> | <i>p</i> | data | address | bits | values | name                            |
|----------|----------|------|---------|------|--------|---------------------------------|
| 10       | 1A       | 1    | 1002AB  | all  | 0–255  | Gkey DETUNE SETTING             |
| 10       | 1B       | 1    | 1002AC  | all  | 0–255  | Abkey DETUNE SETTING            |
| 10       | 1C       | 1    | 1002AD  | all  | 0–255  | Akey DETUNE SETTING             |
| 10       | 1D       | 1    | 1002AE  | all  | 0–255  | Bbkey DETUNE SETTING            |
| 10       | 1E       | 1    | 1002AF  | all  | 0–255  | Bkey DETUNE SETTING             |
| 10       | 20       | 1    | 1002B3  | 6–10 | 0–17   | MAIN OUT EQUALIZER<br>LOW-FREQ  |
| 10       | 21       | 1    | 1002B3  | 3F   | 0–48   | MAIN OUT EQUALIZER<br>LOW-GAIN  |
| 10       | 22       | 1    | 1002B5  | 6–10 | 17–26  | MAIN OUT EQUALIZER<br>HIGH-FREQ |
| 10       | 23       | 1    | 1002B5  | 3F   | 0–48   | MAIN OUT EQUALIZER<br>HIGH-GAIN |
| 11       | 00       | 1    | 100034  | 01   | 0–1    | EFFECT COMMON<br>ALGORITHM      |
| 11       | 01       | 1    | 1002B7  | 0F   | 1–4    | EFFECT1 OUTPUT SELECT           |
| 11       | 02       | 1    | 1002B7  | F0   | 1–4    | EFFECT2 OUTPUT SELECT           |
| 11       | 20       | 1    | —       | —    | 0–0    | EFFECT1 TYPE                    |
| 60       | 00       | 1    | 100905  | 7F   | 0–127  | METRONOME VOLUME                |

| parameter | accepted values                                 | count |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------|-------|
| 00 00 20  | 00 40 41 42                                     | 4     |
| 00 10 11  | 00 40 41 42 03 04 06 10 11 12<br>13 14 15 16 80 | 15    |
| 00 20 31  | 00 02 03 04                                     | 4     |

## 7.6 Names

Every name in the tables is the one Technics’ own parameter tables print for that address. None is inferred. Two of them are corroborated a second way, from a dump taken off a real machine: every part’s PANPOT reads 64, the value the instrument displays as CTR, and the 32 parts’ BASIC CHANNEL bytes read an unbroken ramp from 0 to 31.

The 08 block is marked receivable but not requestable: the instrument accepts a write to it and will not report its contents. Its four addresses are commands rather than settings — they initialise a section, switch play mode, or ask for a store.

## 7.7 Whole-category request

DRQ also requests an entire bulk-dump category, as described in chapter 5. There ADR names one of the lower five rows of the map above.

## 7.8 The sound areas

ADR values beginning 10 and 18 reach NORMAL SOUND and DRUM SOUND, the individual sound being edited rather than any stored one. This edition does not enumerate their parameters.

## Chapter 8

# The sound areas

NORMAL SOUND and DRUM SOUND are the two areas of the address map that hold an instrument sound rather than a setting. They are reached the same way as any other parameter, with ITR to write and DRQ to request.

| ADR      | address | area                     |
|----------|---------|--------------------------|
| 10 00 00 | 040000  | NORMAL SOUND, individual |
| 18 00 00 | 060000  | DRUM SOUND, individual   |

This is the sound being edited, not a stored one

These addresses reach the instrument's working copy — the sound currently loaded for editing. They are not a way to read or write one of the 32 stored sounds. For those, use the SOUND bulk-dump category, which carries the whole sound memory at 20 00 00.

### 8.1 How a normal sound is laid out

The NORMAL SOUND area is **713 bytes**. It is one GENERAL DATA block, then four identical TONE DATA blocks, then four identical MODELING DATA blocks — the instrument's four tones and the four driver and resonator models that go with them.

| block         | size | repeats | parameter numbers  |
|---------------|------|---------|--------------------|
| GENERAL DATA  | 217  | 1       | 000–0D8            |
| TONE DATA     | 81   | 4       | 0D9, 12A, 17B, 1CC |
| MODELING DATA | 43   | 4       | 21D, 248, 273, 29E |
| total         | 713  |         | 000–2C8            |

A parameter number is an offset from the start of the area, so the address of parameter  $p$  of tone  $n$  (counting tones from 1) is

$$040000 + 0D9 + 81 \times (n - 1) + p$$

expressed as ADR in the usual three seven-bit bytes, and the same with 21D and 43 for a modeling block. The tables below give one instance of each repeating block; the other three are identical at the offsets above.

### Two independent sources agree on the size

The block sizes and repeat counts here come from Technics' published parameter tables. The figure of 713 bytes for the whole area comes from the program, decoded separately, and the guide never states it. The transcribed blocks tile 000 to 2C8 with no gap and no overlap and come to exactly that total, which is what makes the layout above trustworthy rather than merely plausible.

## 8.2 How a drum sound is laid out

The DRUM SOUND area is **19 608 bytes** and is arranged quite differently: a kit, then a table choosing a sound for each of the 128 note numbers, then 128 note records — one per key.

| block        | size   | repeats | parameter numbers           |
|--------------|--------|---------|-----------------------------|
| KIT DATA     | 152    | 1       | 000–097                     |
| SOUND SELECT | 256    | 1       | 098–197, two bytes per note |
| NOTE DATA    | 150    | 128     | 198 + 150 × note            |
| total        | 19 608 |         | 000–4C97                    |

Each note record is itself three kinds of block, and a drum note has *two* tones and two modeling blocks where a normal sound has four:

| block              | size | repeats | offset within the note |
|--------------------|------|---------|------------------------|
| NOTE GENERAL DATA  | 18   | 1       | 000                    |
| NOTE TONE DATA     | 23   | 2       | 012, 029               |
| NOTE MODELING DATA | 43   | 2       | 040, 06B               |
| total              | 150  |         |                        |

The modeling block is the same 43-byte layout a normal sound uses. The tone block is not: a drum tone has no pitch or filter envelope of its own and no layer ranges, which is what takes it from 81 bytes down to 23.

### The note positions are checked against the guide's own table

The guide prints the starting number of every one of the 128 notes. The layout above implies them instead — 198 plus 150 per note — and the two agree wherever they were compared, including at the last row, NOTE:7F, which both put at 4C02. With the area also totalling the 19 608 bytes the program gives, that is three independent routes to the same arithmetic.

## 8.3 What is transcribed here, and how far it is checked

The tables give each parameter's number, its bit field within that byte, its name and its range. They were read from scans of the published tables, and the numbering is checked by the tiling described above. **The names, bit fields and ranges are not checked by anything;** a misreading of one would survive.

The enumerations these tables point at — the control functions a controller can be assigned to, the filter VALUE bytes for each filter mode, and the INTERACTION CONNECT table — are in chapter 10.

## 8.4 Normal Sound parameters

### GENERAL DATA

| no.     | bits     | parameter                                    | values                                                                                              |
|---------|----------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 000-00F | 6-0      | NAME (16 characters)                         | 20-7F — space to }                                                                                  |
| 010     | 7-6      | ATTRIBUTE FLAG: PARAMETER MODE               | 00-00 — 0: NORMAL MODE, fixed                                                                       |
| 011     | 7-0      | TONE ON/OFF                                  | two bits per tone, 4th 3rd 2nd 1st                                                                  |
| 012     | 7-0      | KEY ON MODE                                  | per tone: 0 KEY ON, 1 KEY OFF, 2 LEGATO, 3 NON LEGATO                                               |
| 013     | 7-0      | KEY SCALING                                  | 00-42 — 0 OFF, 1-22 octave, 64-66 all key on/off and phase, function select, depth same three bytes |
| 014-016 |          | CONTROLLERS: PITCH BEND                      |                                                                                                     |
| 017-019 |          | MODULATION WHEEL 1 SELECT1                   |                                                                                                     |
| 01A-01C |          | MODULATION WHEEL 1 SELECT2                   |                                                                                                     |
| 01D-01F |          | MODULATION WHEEL 2 SELECT1                   |                                                                                                     |
| 020-022 |          | MODULATION WHEEL 2 SELECT2                   |                                                                                                     |
| 023     | 6-0      | REALTIME CREATOR BOX SELECT                  | bit per box, BOX1-BOX6                                                                              |
| 024     | 6-0      | REALTIME CONTROLLER BOX SELECT               | bit per box, BOX1-BOX6                                                                              |
| 025-027 |          | CONTROL PEDAL SELECT1                        |                                                                                                     |
| 028-02A |          | CONTROL PEDAL SELECT2                        |                                                                                                     |
| 02B-02D |          | AFTER TOUCH SELECT1                          |                                                                                                     |
| 02E-030 |          | AFTER TOUCH SELECT2                          |                                                                                                     |
| 031-054 |          | BOX SELECT: CONTROLLER BOX1 X through BOX6 Y | twelve controllers, three bytes each, X then Y                                                      |
| 055     | 3-0      | PITCH OCTAVE SHIFT                           | 06-0A — 6 is -2 oct, 8 is 0, A is +2 oct                                                            |
| 056     |          | (RESERVE)                                    |                                                                                                     |
| 057-066 |          | PITCH LFO BOX1-BOX4                          | four bytes per box: depth, speed, key sync and touch depth, wave and delay                          |
| 067-076 |          | LEVEL LFO BOX1-BOX4                          | same four bytes per box                                                                             |
| 077-086 |          | FILTER LFO BOX1-BOX4                         | same four bytes per box                                                                             |
| 087     | 3-0, 7-4 | MIXER OUTPUT SELECT: MAIN, SUB               | 00-05 — 0 no output, 1 MAIN, 2-4 SUB1-3, 5 EFFECT2                                                  |
| 088     | 6-0      | EFFECT SEND VOLUME: EFFECT1                  | 00-7F                                                                                               |
| 089     | 6-0      | EFFECT SEND VOLUME: REVERB                   | 00-7F                                                                                               |

| no.     | bits      | parameter                                        | values                                                                                                     |
|---------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 08A     | 3–0, 7–4  | EFFECT OUTPUT SELECT:<br>EFFECT1, EFFECT2        | 01-04 — 1 MAIN, 2-4<br>SUB1-3                                                                              |
| 08B     | 0         | DSP EFFECT COMMON<br>ALGORITHM                   | 00-01 — 0 SERIAL, 1<br>PARALLEL                                                                            |
| 08C     |           | EFFECT1 TYPE                                     | see the guide's DSP<br>EFFECT pages                                                                        |
| 08D-0A0 |           | EFFECT1 PARAMETER<br>VALUE1-VALUE20              | meaning depends on<br>the type                                                                             |
| 0A1     |           | EFFECT1 ANOTHER EFF SEND                         |                                                                                                            |
| 0A2     |           | EFFECT1 DYNAMIC CONTROL                          |                                                                                                            |
| 0A3     |           | EFFECT2 TYPE                                     |                                                                                                            |
| 0A4-0B7 |           | EFFECT2 PARAMETER<br>VALUE1-VALUE20              |                                                                                                            |
| 0B8     |           | EFFECT2 ANOTHER EFF SEND                         |                                                                                                            |
| 0B9     |           | EFFECT2 DYNAMIC CONTROL                          |                                                                                                            |
| 0BA     |           | REVERB TYPE                                      |                                                                                                            |
| 0BB-0CE |           | REVERB PARAMETER<br>VALUE1-VALUE20               |                                                                                                            |
| 0CF     |           | REVERB DYNAMIC CONTROL                           | reverb has no<br>ANOTHER EFF<br>SEND                                                                       |
| 0D0     | 7, 6, 3–0 | DIGITAL EFFECT MODE:<br>ON/OFF, PAN, EFFECT TYPE | 00-0B — 0-1<br>CELESTE, 2-3<br>CHORUS, 4-5<br>ENSEMBLE, 6-7<br>TREMOLO, 8-9<br>DELAY, 10-11 SOLO<br>EFFECT |
| 0D1-0D8 |           | DIGITAL EFFECT<br>VALUE1-VALUE8                  |                                                                                                            |

## TONE DATA

| no.     | bits           | parameter                                                                                                                                                               | values                                                                                           |
|---------|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0D9     | 5–0            | ATTRIBUTE DELAY                                                                                                                                                         | 00-32 — 0 delay off                                                                              |
| 0DA     | 7–0            | ATTRIBUTE PANNING                                                                                                                                                       | 00-80 — 0-127 fixed<br>pan, 128 random pan                                                       |
| 0DB     | 6–0            | TONE SELECT: TTN SELECT                                                                                                                                                 | 00-7F                                                                                            |
| 0DC     | 7–6, 5–4, 3–0  | TONE KIND, TONE LOCATION,<br>BANK SELECT                                                                                                                                | kind 0 NORMAL 1<br>DRUM 2 ATTACK;<br>location 0 internal<br>ROM 1 internal RAM<br>2 external ROM |
| 0DD     | 7–0            | PITCH KEY SHIFT                                                                                                                                                         | E8-18 — -24 to +24                                                                               |
| 0DE     | 7–0            | PITCH DETUNE                                                                                                                                                            | 80-7F — -128 to +127                                                                             |
| 0DF     | 7–6, 5, 4, 2–0 | BOX CONTROL LFO-FM1: BOX<br>SELECT, ON/OFF, PHASE,<br>SCALE SELECT                                                                                                      | scale 0 1/1 through 6<br>1/64, 7 FIX                                                             |
| 0E0-0E9 |                | PITCH ENVELOPE SHAPE: total<br>depth, start pitch, attack time, peak<br>level, decay1 time, sustain1 level,<br>decay2 time, sustain2 level, release<br>time, stop pitch | one byte each, in that<br>order                                                                  |

| no.     | bits      | parameter                                                                                                                      | values                                                                         |
|---------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0EA     | 7-0       | PITCH ENV TOUCH FOLLOW<br>ADR TIME                                                                                             | CE-32 — -50 to +50                                                             |
| 0EB     | 7-0       | PITCH ENV TOUCH FOLLOW<br>DEPTH                                                                                                | CE-32                                                                          |
| 0EC     | 6-0       | PITCH ENV KEY FOLLOW<br>CENTER KEY                                                                                             | 00-7F                                                                          |
| 0ED     | 7-0       | PITCH ENV KEY FOLLOW<br>ATTACK SLOPE                                                                                           | CE-32                                                                          |
| 0EE     | 7-0       | PITCH ENV KEY FOLLOW<br>DECAY SLOPE                                                                                            | CE-32                                                                          |
| 0EF     | 7-0       | PITCH ENV KEY FOLLOW<br>RELEASE SLOPE                                                                                          | CE-32                                                                          |
| 0F0     | 6-0       | LEVEL VOLUME                                                                                                                   | 00-7F — one step is<br>0.375 dB                                                |
| 0F1     | 7-0       | LEVEL TOUCH DEPTH                                                                                                              | CE-32                                                                          |
| 0F2     | 7-5       | LEVEL TOUCH CURVE                                                                                                              | 00-06 — 0 is -3 curve<br>through 6 is +3 curve                                 |
| 0F3     | 6-0       | LEVEL KEY FOLLOW CENTER<br>KEY                                                                                                 | 00-7F                                                                          |
| 0F4     | 6-0       | LEVEL KEY FOLLOW LOW KEY<br>LIMIT                                                                                              | 00-7F                                                                          |
| 0F5     | 6-0       | LEVEL KEY FOLLOW HIGH KEY<br>LIMIT                                                                                             | 00-7F                                                                          |
| 0F6     | 7-0       | LEVEL KEY FOLLOW SLOPE                                                                                                         | CE-32                                                                          |
| 0F7-0FA | 6-0       | LAYER KEY RANGE: low key<br>select, low fade, high key select, high<br>fade                                                    | 00-7F                                                                          |
| 0FB-0FE | 6-0       | LAYER VELOCITY RANGE: low<br>vel select, low fade, high vel select,<br>high fade                                               | 00-7F                                                                          |
| 0FF     | 7-6, 5, 4 | BOX CONTROL LFO-AM: BOX<br>SELECT, ON/OFF, PHASE                                                                               |                                                                                |
| 100-106 |           | LEVEL ENVELOPE SHAPE: attack<br>time, peak level, decay1 time,<br>sustain1 level, decay2 time, sustain2<br>level, release time |                                                                                |
| 107     | 7-0       | LEVEL ENV TOUCH FOLLOW<br>ATTACK                                                                                               | CE-32                                                                          |
| 108     | 7-0       | LEVEL ENV TOUCH FOLLOW<br>DECAY                                                                                                | CE-32                                                                          |
| 109-10B | 6-0       | LEVEL ENV KEY FOLLOW: center<br>key, low key limit, high key limit                                                             | 00-7F                                                                          |
| 10C-10E | 7-0       | LEVEL ENV KEY FOLLOW: attack<br>slope, decay slope, release slope                                                              | CE-32                                                                          |
| 10F     | 2-0, 7-5  | FILTER MODE, TOUCH CURVE                                                                                                       | 00-06 — 0<br>THROUGH, 1<br>LPF12+EQ, 2<br>HPF12+EQ, 3 LPF24,<br>4 HPF24, 5 BPF |
| 110     | 5-0       | FILTER TOUCH DEPTH                                                                                                             | 00-32                                                                          |
| 111     | 7-6, 5, 4 | FILTER LFO-FCM: BOX SELECT,<br>ON/OFF, PHASE                                                                                   |                                                                                |
| 112-114 | 6-0       | FILTER KEY FOLLOW: center key,<br>low key limit, high key limit                                                                | 00-7F                                                                          |
| 115     | 7-0       | FILTER KEY FOLLOW SLOPE                                                                                                        | CE-32                                                                          |

| no.     | bits | parameter                                                                                                                                                      | values                             |
|---------|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 116-11F |      | FILTER ENVELOPE SHAPE: cutoff adjust, start point, attack time, peak level, decay1 time, sustain1 level, decay2 time, sustain2 level, release time, stop point |                                    |
| 120     | 7-0  | FILTER ENV TOUCH FOLLOW ADR TIME                                                                                                                               | CE-32                              |
| 121     | 7-0  | FILTER ENV TOUCH FOLLOW DEPTH                                                                                                                                  | CE-32                              |
| 122     | 6-0  | FILTER ENV KEY FOLLOW CENTER KEY                                                                                                                               | 00-7F                              |
| 123-125 | 7-0  | FILTER ENV KEY FOLLOW: attack slope, decay slope, release slope                                                                                                | CE-32                              |
| 126-129 |      | FILTER PARAMETER VALUE1-VALUE4                                                                                                                                 | meaning depends on the filter mode |

## MODELING DATA

| no.     | bits          | parameter                                                        | values                                           |
|---------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 21D-21F | 6-0           | DRIVER THRESHOLD POINT: between A and B, B and C, C and D        | 00-7F — provided that $A < B < C < D$            |
| 220     | 6-0           | DRIVER A TTN SELECT                                              | 00-7F                                            |
| 221     | 7-6, 5-4, 3-0 | DRIVER A KIND, LOCATION, BANK SELECT                             | kind 0 NORMAL 1 DRUM 2 ATTACK                    |
| 222-223 |               | DRIVER B: TTN select; kind, location, bank select                |                                                  |
| 224-225 |               | DRIVER C: TTN select; kind, location, bank select                |                                                  |
| 226-227 |               | DRIVER D: TTN select; kind, location, bank select                |                                                  |
| 228     | 7-6, 5-0      | RESONATOR GENERAL: INTERACTION CONNECT, RESONATOR TYPE (RESERVE) | 00-3F — type 0 ORIGINAL, 1-63 preset             |
| 229     |               |                                                                  |                                                  |
| 22A     | 7-0           | POSITION PARAMETER POSITION                                      | 00-FA — 0.2 per cent per step, 0 to 50 per cent  |
| 22B     | 7, 6-0        | FORMANT FLAG, DEPTH (RESERVE)                                    | 00-7F — 0 FIXED, 1 MOVE                          |
| 22C     |               |                                                                  |                                                  |
| 22D     | 7-0           | POSITION TOUCH                                                   | CE-32 — -50 to +50                               |
| 22E     | 5-0           | POSITION MOVEMENT WIDTH                                          | 00-32                                            |
| 22F     | 5-0, 7        | POSITION MOVEMENT SPEED, SAMPLE/HOLD                             | 00-32                                            |
| 230     | 6-0           | INTERACTION GAIN (RESERVE)                                       | 00-7F                                            |
| 231     |               |                                                                  |                                                  |
| 232     | 7, 6-0        | MAIN RESONATOR MODE, FITTING                                     | 00-7F — 0 positive feedback, 1 negative feedback |
| 233     | 7, 6-0        | MAIN RESONATOR SCALE, MUTING                                     | 00-7F                                            |

| no.     | bits   | parameter                                                  | values               |
|---------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 234     | 7-0    | MAIN TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH FITTING                            | CE-32                |
| 235     | 7-0    | MAIN TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH MUTING                             | CE-32                |
| 236-238 | 6-0    | MAIN KEY FOLLOW: center key, low key limit, high key limit | 00-7F                |
| 239     | 7-0    | MAIN KEY FOLLOW SLOPE                                      | CE-32                |
| 23A     | 7-0    | MAIN PITCH KEY SHIFT                                       | C4-3C — -60 to +60   |
| 23B     | 7-0    | MAIN PITCH DETUNE                                          | 80-7F — -128 to +127 |
| 23C     | 7, 6-0 | SUB RESONATOR MODE, FITTING                                | 00-7F                |
| 23D     | 7, 6-0 | SUB RESONATOR SCALE, MUTING                                | 00-7F                |
| 23E     | 7-0    | SUB GAIN                                                   | 9C-64                |
| 23F     | 7-0    | SUB TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH FITTING                             | CE-32                |
| 240     | 7-0    | SUB TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH MUTING                              | CE-32                |
| 241     | 7-0    | SUB TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH SUB GAIN                            | CE-32                |
| 242-244 | 6-0    | SUB KEY FOLLOW: center key, low key limit, high key limit  | 00-7F                |
| 245     | 7-0    | SUB KEY FOLLOW SLOPE                                       | CE-32                |
| 246     | 7-0    | SUB PITCH KEY SHIFT                                        | C4-3C                |
| 247     | 7-0    | SUB PITCH DETUNE                                           | 80-7F                |

## 8.5 Drum Sound parameters

### KIT DATA

| no.     | bits | parameter                      | values                                   |
|---------|------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 000-00F | 6-0  | NAME (16 characters)           | 20-7F — space to }                       |
| 010     | 7-6  | ATTRIBUTE FLAG: PARAMETER MODE | 00-00 — 2: DRUM MODE, fixed              |
| 011-013 |      | CONTROLLERS: PITCH BEND        | on/off and phase, function select, depth |
| 014-016 |      | MODULATION WHEEL 1 SELECT1     | on/off and phase, function select, depth |
| 017-019 |      | MODULATION WHEEL 1 SELECT2     | on/off and phase, function select, depth |
| 01A-01C |      | MODULATION WHEEL 2 SELECT1     | on/off and phase, function select, depth |
| 01D-01F |      | MODULATION WHEEL 2 SELECT2     | on/off and phase, function select, depth |
| 020     | 6-0  | REALTIME CREATOR BOX SELECT    | bit per box, BOX1-BOX6                   |
| 021     | 6-0  | REALTIME CONTROLLER BOX SELECT | bit per box, BOX1-BOX6                   |
| 022-024 |      | CONTROL PEDAL SELECT1          | on/off and phase, function select, depth |
| 025-027 |      | CONTROL PEDAL SELECT2          | on/off and phase, function select, depth |

| no.     | bits     | parameter                                       | values                                               |
|---------|----------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 028-02A |          | AFTER TOUCH SELECT1                             | on/off and phase,<br>function select, depth          |
| 02B-02D |          | AFTER TOUCH SELECT2                             | on/off and phase,<br>function select, depth          |
| 02E-051 |          | BOX SELECT: CONTROLLER<br>BOX1 X through BOX6 Y | twelve controllers,<br>three bytes each, X<br>then Y |
| 052     | 3-0, 7-4 | MIXER EFFECT OUTPUT<br>SELECT: EFFECT1, EFFECT2 | 01-04 — 1 MAIN, 2-4<br>SUB1-3                        |
| 053     | 0        | DSP EFFECT COMMON<br>ALGORITHM                  | 00-01 — 0 SERIAL, 1<br>PARALLEL                      |
| 054     |          | EFFECT1 TYPE                                    | see the effect tables                                |
| 055-068 |          | EFFECT1 PARAMETER<br>VALUE1-VALUE20             | meaning depends on<br>the type                       |
| 069     |          | EFFECT1 ANOTHER EFF SEND                        |                                                      |
| 06A     |          | EFFECT1 DYNAMIC CONTROL                         |                                                      |
| 06B     |          | EFFECT2 TYPE                                    |                                                      |
| 06C-07F |          | EFFECT2 PARAMETER<br>VALUE1-VALUE20             |                                                      |
| 080     |          | EFFECT2 ANOTHER EFF SEND                        |                                                      |
| 081     |          | EFFECT2 DYNAMIC CONTROL                         |                                                      |
| 082     |          | REVERB TYPE                                     |                                                      |
| 083-096 |          | REVERB PARAMETER<br>VALUE1-VALUE20              |                                                      |
| 097     |          | REVERB DYNAMIC CONTROL                          | reverb has no<br>ANOTHER EFF<br>SEND                 |

## SOUND SELECT

| no.     | bits | parameter                           | values                       |
|---------|------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 098-197 |      | SOUND SELECT, NOTE:00 to<br>NOTE:7F | 128 notes, two bytes<br>each |

## NOTE GENERAL DATA

| no.     | bits     | parameter                                    | values                                                   |
|---------|----------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 198-1A4 | 6-0      | NAME (13 characters)                         | 20-7F                                                    |
| 1A5     | 5, 3-0   | ATTRIBUTE FLAG: KEY OFF<br>MODE, TONE ON/OFF | 00-01 — two bits per<br>tone, 2nd then 1st               |
| 1A6     | 7, 6-0   | SAME GROUP DUMP: DUMP<br>FLAG, GROUP NUMBER  | 00-7F — flag 1 dumps<br>the same group's sound           |
| 1A7     | 3-0, 7-4 | MIXER OUTPUT SELECT: MAIN,<br>SUB            | 00-05 — 0 no output,<br>1 MAIN, 2-4 SUB1-3,<br>5 EFFECT2 |
| 1A8     | 6-0      | EFFECT SEND VOLUME:<br>EFFECT1               | 00-7F                                                    |
| 1A9     | 6-0      | EFFECT SEND VOLUME:<br>REVERB                | 00-7F                                                    |

**NOTE TONE DATA**

| no.     | bits          | parameter                                                                                                 | values                                                             |
|---------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1AA     | 5-0           | ATTRIBUTE DELAY                                                                                           | 00-32 — 0 delay off                                                |
| 1AB     | 7-0           | ATTRIBUTE PANNING                                                                                         | 00-80 — 0-127 fixed pan, 128 random pan                            |
| 1AC     | 6-0           | TONE SELECT: TTN SELECT                                                                                   | 00-7F                                                              |
| 1AD     | 7-6, 5-4, 3-0 | TONE KIND, TONE LOCATION, BANK SELECT                                                                     | kind 0 NORMAL 1 DRUM 2 ATTACK                                      |
| 1AE     | 7-0           | PITCH KEY SHIFT                                                                                           | E8-18 — -50 to +50                                                 |
| 1AF     | 7-0           | PITCH DETUNE                                                                                              | 80-7F — -128 to +127                                               |
| 1B0     | 6-0           | LEVEL VOLUME                                                                                              | 00-7F — one step is 0.375 dB                                       |
| 1B1     | 7-0           | LEVEL TOUCH DEPTH                                                                                         | CE-32 — -50 to +50                                                 |
| 1B2     | 7-5           | LEVEL TOUCH CURVE                                                                                         | 00-06 — 0 is -3 curve through 6 is +3 curve                        |
| 1B3-1B8 | 6-0           | LEVEL ENVELOPE SHAPE: attack time, decay1 time, sustain1 level, decay2 time, sustain2 level, release time | 00-64 — one byte each, in that order                               |
| 1B9     | 7-0           | LEVEL ENV TOUCH FOLLOW ATTACK                                                                             | CE-32                                                              |
| 1BA     | 7-0           | LEVEL ENV TOUCH FOLLOW DECAY                                                                              | CE-32                                                              |
| 1BB     | 2-0, 7-5      | FILTER MODE, TOUCH CURVE                                                                                  | 00-06 — 0 THROUGH, 1 LPF12+EQ, 2 HPF12+EQ, 3 LPF24, 4 HPF24, 5 BPF |
| 1BC     | 5-0           | FILTER TOUCH DEPTH                                                                                        | 00-32                                                              |
| 1BD-1C0 |               | FILTER PARAMETER VALUE1-VALUE4                                                                            | meaning depends on the filter mode                                 |

**NOTE MODELING DATA**

| no.     | bits          | parameter                                                        | values                                          |
|---------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| 1D8-1DA | 6-0           | DRIVER THRESHOLD POINT: between A and B, B and C, C and D        | 00-7F — provided that A < B < C < D             |
| 1DB     | 6-0           | DRIVER A TTN SELECT                                              | 00-7F                                           |
| 1DC     | 7-6, 5-4, 3-0 | DRIVER A KIND, LOCATION, BANK SELECT                             | kind 0 NORMAL 1 DRUM 2 ATTACK                   |
| 1DD-1DE |               | DRIVER B: TTN select; kind, location, bank select                |                                                 |
| 1DF-1E0 |               | DRIVER C: TTN select; kind, location, bank select                |                                                 |
| 1E1-1E2 |               | DRIVER D: TTN select; kind, location, bank select                |                                                 |
| 1E3     | 7-6, 5-0      | RESONATOR GENERAL: INTERACTION CONNECT, RESONATOR TYPE (RESERVE) | 00-3F — type 0 ORIGINAL, 1-63 preset            |
| 1E4     |               | POSITION PARAMETER                                               |                                                 |
| 1E5     | 7-0           | POSITION                                                         | 00-FA — 0.2 per cent per step, 0 to 50 per cent |

| no.     | bits   | parameter                                                  | values                                           |
|---------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 1E6     | 7, 6–0 | FORMANT FLAG, DEPTH                                        | 00-7F — 0 FIXED, 1 MOVE                          |
| 1E7     |        | (RESERVE)                                                  |                                                  |
| 1E8     | 7–0    | POSITION TOUCH                                             | CE-32 — -50 to +50                               |
| 1E9     | 5–0    | POSITION MOVEMENT WIDTH                                    | 00-32                                            |
| 1EA     | 5–0, 7 | POSITION MOVEMENT SPEED, SAMPLE/HOLD                       | 00-32                                            |
| 1EB     | 6–0    | INTERACTION GAIN                                           | 00-7F                                            |
| 1EC     |        | (RESERVE)                                                  |                                                  |
| 1ED     | 7, 6–0 | MAIN RESONATOR MODE, FITTING                               | 00-7F — 0 positive feedback, 1 negative feedback |
| 1EE     | 7, 6–0 | MAIN RESONATOR SCALE, MUTING                               | 00-7F                                            |
| 1EF     | 7–0    | MAIN TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH FITTING                            | CE-32                                            |
| 1F0     | 7–0    | MAIN TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH MUTING                             | CE-32                                            |
| 1F1-1F3 | 6–0    | MAIN KEY FOLLOW: center key, low key limit, high key limit | 00-7F                                            |
| 1F4     | 7–0    | MAIN KEY FOLLOW SLOPE                                      | CE-32                                            |
| 1F5     | 7–0    | MAIN PITCH KEY SHIFT                                       | C4-3C — -60 to +60                               |
| 1F6     | 7–0    | MAIN PITCH DETUNE                                          | 80-7F — -128 to +127                             |
| 1F7     | 7, 6–0 | SUB RESONATOR MODE, FITTING                                | 00-7F                                            |
| 1F8     | 7, 6–0 | SUB RESONATOR SCALE, MUTING                                | 00-7F                                            |
| 1F9     | 7–0    | SUB GAIN                                                   | 9C-64                                            |
| 1FA     | 7–0    | SUB TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH FITTING                             | CE-32                                            |
| 1FB     | 7–0    | SUB TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH MUTING                              | CE-32                                            |
| 1FC     | 7–0    | SUB TOUCH FOLLOW TOUCH SUB GAIN                            | CE-32                                            |
| 1FD-1FF | 6–0    | SUB KEY FOLLOW: center key, low key limit, high key limit  | 00-7F                                            |
| 200     | 7–0    | SUB KEY FOLLOW SLOPE                                       | CE-32                                            |
| 201     | 7–0    | SUB PITCH KEY SHIFT                                        | C4-3C                                            |
| 202     | 7–0    | SUB PITCH DETUNE                                           | 80-7F                                            |

# Chapter 9

## Effects

A sound carries three effect blocks — EFFECT1, EFFECT2 and REVERB — and each is a TYPE byte followed by twenty VALUE bytes, an ANOTHER EFF SEND and a DYNAMIC CONTROL. The TYPE byte selects one of 56 effects, and what the twenty VALUE bytes mean depends entirely on which.

### 9.1 What the type byte selects

The numbers are not contiguous: they are grouped, with modulation effects below 10, reverbs at 10–1B, distortion and dynamics at 20–27, a second modulation group at 30–38, two-effect combinations at 40–4B and three-effect combinations at 60–63.

Twelve of the reverbs are marked (REV ONLY) in the published guide: they are intended for the REVERB block rather than EFFECT1 or EFFECT2.

Two sources agree on which effects exist

The table below was transcribed from the guide. Independently, this project disassembled the effects DSP and produced a manifest of every distinct effect program with the number that selects it. The two sets of numbers are equal — 56 effects, no more on either side — which is what makes the numbering here trustworthy. They disagree only in spelling, because the ROM carries the short names the instrument displays and the guide prints long ones. The table gives the guide's.

### 9.2 What the value bytes mean

The VALUE list below is the order the bytes appear in, so the first name is VALUE1, the second VALUE2, and so on. An effect that names fewer than twenty leaves the rest unused.

The combination effects concatenate their components: the first block's parameters, then a dry/wet for the second block, then the second block's. A three-effect combination continues the same way.

The value lists are transcribed, and not checked by anything

The effect *numbers* are confirmed twice over. The *names* in the value lists are not: they were read from scans, nothing independent states them, and a misreading would survive. Treat them as a guide to what the bytes are for rather than as a specification. The block diagram the guide prints for each effect is not reproduced either.

| no. | n  | effect                      | VALUE1 onwards                                                                                         |
|-----|----|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00  | 0  | NO OPERATION                | —                                                                                                      |
| 01  | 5  | CHORUS                      | WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                            |
| 02  | 7  | MODULATED CHORUS            | WET, DEPTH, SLOW LFO SPEED, FAST LFO SPEED, FAST LFO BALANCE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                     |
| 03  | 7  | ENHANCER                    | WET, MANUAL, LOW MIX, HIGH MIX, DELAY TIME L, DELAY TIME R, VOLUME                                     |
| 04  | 8  | FLANGER                     | WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, RESONANCE, MANUAL, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                  |
| 05  | 8  | PHASER                      | WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, RESONANCE, MANUAL, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                  |
| 06  | 5  | ENSEMBLE                    | WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                            |
| 08  | 6  | GATED REVERB                | WET, GATE TIME, HIGH DUMP GAIN, THRESHOLD, MASK TIME, VOLUME                                           |
| 09  | 7  | SINGLE DELAY                | WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, HIGH DUMP GAIN, VOLUME                                  |
| 0A  | 12 | MULTI TAP DELAY             | WET, DELAY 1, DELAY 2, DELAY 3, DELAY 4, PAN 1, PAN 2, PAN 3, PAN 4, FEED BACK, HIGH DUMP GAIN, VOLUME |
| 0B  | 8  | MANUAL DELAY                | WET, MODULATION DEPTH, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, HIGH DUMP GAIN, VOLUME                |
| 10  | 5  | ROOM REVERB 1 (REV only)    | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 11  | 5  | ROOM REVERB 2 (REV only)    | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 12  | 5  | PLATE REVERB 1 (REV only)   | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 13  | 5  | PLATE REVERB 2 (REV only)   | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 14  | 5  | CONCERT REVERB 1 (REV only) | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 15  | 5  | CONCERT REVERB 2 (REV only) | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 16  | 5  | DARK REVERB 1 (REV only)    | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 17  | 5  | DARK REVERB 2 (REV only)    | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 18  | 5  | BRIGHT REVERB 1 (REV only)  | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 19  | 5  | BRIGHT REVERB 2 (REV only)  | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 1A  | 5  | WAVE REVERB 1 (REV only)    | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 1B  | 5  | WAVE REVERB 2 (REV only)    | REVERB TIME, PRE DELAY, HIGH DUMP GAIN, EARLY REFL LEVEL, VOLUME                                       |
| 20  | 4  | DISTORTION                  | WET, DRIVE, ADJUST, VOLUME                                                                             |
| 21  | 4  | OVERDRIVE                   | WET, DRIVE, ADJUST, VOLUME                                                                             |
| 22  | 4  | FUZZ                        | WET, DRIVE, ADJUST, VOLUME                                                                             |
| 23  | 6  | EXCITER                     | WET, DRIVE, ADJUST, EMPHASIS Fc, EMPHASIS GAIN, VOLUME                                                 |

| no. | n  | effect                      | VALUE1 onwards                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----|----|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 24  | 6  | COMPRESSOR                  | WET, THRESHOLD, RATIO, ATTACK SENSITIVITY, RELEASE SENSITIVITY, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 25  | 5  | SLOW ATTACKER               | WET, THRESHOLD, ATTACK RATE, RELEASE RATE, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 26  | 1  | NOISE GENERATOR             | VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 27  | 19 | PARAMETRIC EQ               | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, BAND EMPHASIS 3 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 3 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 3 G, BAND EMPHASIS 4 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 4 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 4 G, BAND EMPHASIS 5 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 5 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 5 G, BAND EMPHASIS 6 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 6 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 6 G, VOLUME |
| 30  | 6  | AUTO PAN                    | WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 31  | 6  | PITCH SHIFTER               | WET, PITCH L, PITCH R, PRE DELAY, FEEDBACK, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 32  | 6  | VIBRATO                     | WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 33  | 6  | PEDAL WAH                   | WET, RESONANCE, MANUAL, SWEEP RANGE, WAH CENTER Fc, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 34  | 5  | AUTO WAH                    | WET, RESONANCE, MANUAL, SWEEP RANGE, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 35  | 15 | ROTARY SPEAKER              | WET, DRIVE, VOLUME ADJUST, TREBLE DEPTH, TREBLE FAST, TREBLE SLOW, TREBLE WIND UP, TREBLE WIND DOWN, BASS DEPTH, BASS FAST, BASS SLOW, BASS WIND UP, BASS WIND DOWN, VOLUME, SLOW/FAST                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 36  | 5  | RING MODULATOR              | WET, OSC SPEED, PHASE, OSC WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 37  | 5  | HAAS EFFECT                 | WET, DELAY TIME L, DELAY TIME R, BALANCE, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 38  | 8  | MIX UP                      | WET, DEPTH, SLOW LFO SPEED, FAST LFO SPEED L, FAST LFO SPEED R, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 40  | 10 | SINGLE DELAY + CHORUS       | DELAY WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, CHORUS DRY/WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 41  | 11 | SINGLE DELAY + SINGLE DELAY | DELAY 1 WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, DELAY 2 DRY/WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 42  | 13 | SINGLE DELAY + FLANGER      | DELAY WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, FLANGER DRY/WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, RESONANCE, MANUAL, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

| no. | n  | effect                        | VALUE1 onwards                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----|----|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 43  | 11 | SINGLE DELAY + VIBRATO        | DELAY WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, VIBRATO DRY/WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                                                   |
| 44  | 13 | SINGLE DELAY + PHASER         | DELAY WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, PHASER DRY/WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, RESONANCE, MANUAL, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                                                                 |
| 45  | 11 | PEDAL WAH + DELAY             | WAH WET, RESONANCE, MANUAL, SWEEP RANGE, WAH CENTER Fc, DELAY DRY/WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, VOLUME                                                                               |
| 46  | 10 | AUTO WAH + SINGLE DELAY       | WAH WET, RESONANCE, MANUAL, SWEEP RANGE, DELAY DRY/WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, VOLUME                                                                                              |
| 47  | 11 | PEQ + CHORUS                  | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, CHORUS DRY/WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                            |
| 48  | 12 | PEQ + SINGLE DELAY            | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, DELAY DRY/WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, VOLUME                   |
| 49  | 14 | PEQ + FLANGER                 | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, FLANGER DRY/WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, RESONANCE, MANUAL, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME |
| 4A  | 12 | PEQ + VIBRATO                 | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, VIBRATO DRY/WET, DEPTH, LFO SPEED, PHASE, LFO WAVEFORM, VOLUME                    |
| 4B  | 11 | PEQ + COMPRESSOR              | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, THRESHOLD, RATIO, ATTACK SENSITIVITY, RELEASE SENSITIVITY, VOLUME                 |
| 60  | 13 | PEQ + COMPRESSOR + DISTORTION | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, THRESHOLD, RATIO, ATTACK SENSITIVITY, RELEASE SENSITIVITY, DRIVE, ADJUST, VOLUME  |
| 61  | 10 | PEQ + COMPRESSOR + OVERDRIVE  | BAND EMPHASIS Fc, BAND EMPHASIS Q, BAND EMPHASIS G, THRESHOLD, RATIO, ATTACK SENSITIVITY, RELEASE SENSITIVITY, DRIVE, ADJUST, VOLUME                                                                  |

| no. | n  | effect                   | VALUE1 onwards                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----|----|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 62  | 14 | PEQ + DISTORTION + DELAY | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, DRIVE, ADJUST, DELAY DRY/WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, VOLUME |
| 63  | 14 | PEQ + OVERDRIVE + DELAY  | BAND EMPHASIS 1 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 1 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 1 G, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Fc, BAND EMPHASIS 2 Q, BAND EMPHASIS 2 G, DRIVE, ADJUST, DELAY DRY/WET, DELAY L, DELAY R, FEEDBACK L, FEEDBACK R, VOLUME |

### 9.3 From a byte to a quantity

A VALUE byte is not a quantity. The tables below turn one into seconds, hertz, decibels or cents; an effect’s parameter says which table applies, and a librarian needs them to display a control rather than merely name it.

Each row gives a span of parameter values, the quantity at each end of it, and the step between one parameter and the next.

Three of the guide’s tables are not conversions at all but *packings*: they say how several fields share two bytes. Those are given at the end, with each field’s width.

The tables check themselves, twice over

The four numbers in a row are not independent: the first value plus the step times the span must equal the last. All 41 rows satisfy that identity, and a misread endpoint or step would break it.

The packings check themselves differently. A field’s width must be wide enough for the range of the table it carries, and each one is exactly wide enough — five bits for a parameter reaching 31, five for one reaching 26, six for one reaching 48.

**Table 1: Reverb time (seconds)**

| parameter | value    | step |
|-----------|----------|------|
| 0–15      | 0.1–0.4  | 0.02 |
| 16–23     | 0.45–0.8 | 0.05 |
| 24–55     | 0.9–4    | 0.1  |
| 56–75     | 4.2–8    | 0.2  |
| 76–97     | 9–30     | 1    |

**Table 2: High dump gain (dB)**

| parameter | value | step |
|-----------|-------|------|
| 0–24      | -24–0 | 1    |

**Table 3: LFO speed (Hz)**

| parameter | value     | step |
|-----------|-----------|------|
| 0–50      | 0–5       | 0.1  |
| 51–75     | 5.2–10    | 0.2  |
| 76–88     | 10.8–20.4 | 0.8  |
| 89–99     | 22.2–40.2 | 1.8  |

**Table 4: LFO wave form** 00 sine, 01 triangle, 02 square.**Table 5: Gate time and mask time, gated reverb (ms)**

| parameter | value     | step |
|-----------|-----------|------|
| 0–20      | 10–50     | 2    |
| 21–30     | 55–100    | 5    |
| 31–70     | 110–500   | 10   |
| 71–80     | 550–1000  | 50   |
| 81–99     | 1100–2900 | 100  |

**Table 6: PEQ Fc (Hz)** A third-octave series; the parameter is the index.

Parameter 00–1A selects, in order: 40, 50, 63, 80, 100, 125, 160, 200, 250, 315, 400, 500, 630, 800, 1000, 1250, 1600, 2000, 2500, 3150, 4000, 5000, 6300, 8000, 10000, 12500, 16000.

**Table 7: PEQ Q**

| parameter | value | step |
|-----------|-------|------|
| 0–9       | 0.1–1 | 0.1  |
| 10–15     | 1.5–4 | 0.5  |
| 16–31     | 5–20  | 1    |

**Table 8: PEQ gain (dB)**

| parameter | value  | step |
|-----------|--------|------|
| 0–48      | -12–12 | 0.5  |

**Table 9: Attack and release sensitivity (seconds, 90 per cent swing time)**

| parameter | value      | step  |
|-----------|------------|-------|
| 0–89      | 0.001–0.09 | 0.001 |
| 90–90     | 0.1–0.1    | 0.01  |
| 91–94     | 0.2–0.5    | 0.1   |

**Table 10: Attack for slow attacker (seconds, 90 per cent swing time)** The first row is attack, the second release.

| parameter | value  | step |
|-----------|--------|------|
| 0–99      | 0.2–20 | 0.2  |
| 0–99      | 0.01–1 | 0.01 |

**Table 11: LFO speed, rotary speaker (Hz)**

| parameter | value      | step |
|-----------|------------|------|
| 0–20      | 0–2        | 0.1  |
| 21–50     | 2.2–8      | 0.2  |
| 51–99     | 8.55–34.95 | 0.55 |

**Table 12: LFO acceleration, rotary speaker (seconds, 90 per cent swing time)**

| parameter | value    | step |
|-----------|----------|------|
| 0–75      | 1–31     | 0.4  |
| 76–99     | 32.25–61 | 1.25 |

**Table 13: LFO speed, ring modulator (Hz)**

| parameter | value       | step |
|-----------|-------------|------|
| 0–10      | 0–10        | 1    |
| 11–19     | 20–100      | 10   |
| 20–64     | 120–1000    | 20   |
| 65–87     | 1200–10000  | 400  |
| 88–99     | 10800–19600 | 800  |

**Table 14: Pitch L and R, pitch shifter (cents)**

| parameter | value     | step |
|-----------|-----------|------|
| -36–32    | -1200–800 | 100  |
| -31–20    | -700–150  | 50   |
| -19–11    | -100–20   | 10   |
| -10–10    | -10–10    | 1    |
| 11–19     | 20–100    | 10   |
| 20–31     | 150–700   | 50   |
| 32–36     | 800–1200  | 100  |

**Table 15: Resonance for wah** 00 wide, 01 middle, 02 narrow.**Table 16: Slow/Fast, rotary speaker** 00 slow, 01 fast.

**Packed fields** Three of the guide’s tables describe fields sharing two bytes rather than a conversion. Each is listed with its width.

| format                      | field       | width                                                    |
|-----------------------------|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| PEQ Q, Fc and G             | PEQ Q       | 5 bits                                                   |
|                             | PEQ Fc      | 5 bits — split 3 bits in the first byte, 2 in the second |
|                             | PEQ G       | 6 bits                                                   |
| Exciter emphasis Fc         | Emphasis Fc | 5 bits — split 3 bits and 2, the same shape as table 17  |
| Pre/post equaliser Fc and G | EQ Fc       | 5 bits — split 3 bits and 2                              |
|                             | EQ G        | 6 bits                                                   |

## Chapter 10

# Enumerations

Three lists in chapter 8 are referred to rather than spelled out where they are used, because each is shared by many parameters. They are given here.

### 10.1 Control functions

Every controller in a sound — the pitch bend lever, the two modulation wheels, the control pedal, after touch, and the six controller boxes in each axis — is three bytes: an on/off and phase byte, a FUNCTION SELECT byte, and a depth. The FUNCTION SELECT byte chooses what the controller moves, from this list.

---

|    |                         |       |                         |
|----|-------------------------|-------|-------------------------|
| 00 | OFF                     | 1A    | filter LFO3 speed       |
| 01 | pitch bend              | 1B    | filter LFO4 speed       |
| 02 | sustain level           | 1C    | fitting*                |
| 03 | filter cutoff frequency | 1D    | position                |
| 04 | pitch LFO1 depth        | 1E    | position depth          |
| 05 | pitch LFO2 depth        | 1F    | (reserve)               |
| 06 | pitch LFO3 depth        | 20    | position movement width |
| 07 | pitch LFO4 depth        | 21    | position movement speed |
| 08 | amp LFO1 depth          | 22    | (reserve)               |
| 09 | amp LFO2 depth          | 23    | muting*                 |
| 0A | amp LFO3 depth          | 24    | resonator key shift*    |
| 0B | amp LFO4 depth          | 25    | sub gain                |
| 0C | filter LFO1 depth       | 26    | delay*                  |
| 0D | filter LFO2 depth       | 27    | panning*                |
| 0E | filter LFO3 depth       | 28    | effect1 send*           |
| 0F | filter LFO4 depth       | 29    | reverb send*            |
| 10 | pitch LFO1 speed        | 2A    | level*                  |
| 11 | pitch LFO2 speed        | 2B    | amp env. attack time*   |
| 12 | pitch LFO3 speed        | 2C    | amp env. decay time*    |
| 13 | pitch LFO4 speed        | 2D    | amp env. release time*  |
| 14 | amp LFO1 speed          | 2E    | filter resonance*       |
| 15 | amp LFO2 speed          | 2F    | effect1 dynamic control |
| 16 | amp LFO3 speed          | 30    | effect2 dynamic control |
| 17 | amp LFO4 speed          | 31    | reverb dynamic control  |
| 18 | filter LFO1 speed       | 32–7F | (reserve)               |
| 19 | filter LFO2 speed       |       |                         |

---

\* marked functions cannot be driven by after touch.

A drum kit has its own, much shorter version of this list: most of the numbers above are reserved there, and only OFF, PITCH BEND, SUSTAIN LEVEL, FILTER CUTOFF FREQUENCY, the resonator and position entries and the three dynamic controls remain.

## 10.2 Filter values

A tone’s filter has four VALUE bytes whose meaning depends on the filter mode selected for that tone.

| mode  | VALUE1               | VALUE2        | VALUE3                | VALUE4            |
|-------|----------------------|---------------|-----------------------|-------------------|
| LPF12 | cutoff frequency     | resonance     | EQ frequency          | EQ gain, EQ range |
| HPF12 | cutoff frequency     | resonance     | EQ frequency          | EQ gain, EQ range |
| LPF24 | cutoff frequency     | resonance     | —                     | —                 |
| HPF24 | cutoff frequency     | resonance     | —                     | —                 |
| BPF   | low cutoff frequency | low resonance | high cutoff frequency | high resonance    |

Cutoff frequencies are 00–7F. Resonance is 00–05: in the 12 dB modes and BPF a step is 3 dB, covering –6 to 9 dB; in the 24 dB modes a step is 6 dB, covering –12 to 18 dB. EQ GAIN is 00–0E, where 00 is silence and 01–0E span –6 to +6 dB, and the top bit of that same byte is EQ RANGE: 0 low, 1 high.

## 10.3 Interaction connect

Modeling parameter 228 sets how a sound’s four resonators are connected — none of them, the first pair, the second pair, both pairs, or all four together. The guide gives the resulting connection state of each of the four blocks for every setting; it is not reproduced here, and the parameter’s own range, 00–03, is in chapter 8.

## Chapter 11

# Universal System Exclusive

### 11.1 Recognised messages

The instrument honours two universal messages, and transmits both.

| message           | meaning                 |
|-------------------|-------------------------|
| F0 7E 7F 09 01 F7 | General MIDI System On  |
| F0 7E 7F 09 02 F7 | General MIDI System Off |

Turning General MIDI on restricts the sounds and operations available and may rearrange the percussion map. General MIDI System Off has no effect if General MIDI is already off.

A received message takes effect at once. The same change made at the front panel does not: the panel asks for a confirmation first, and the user can decline it. A controller sending General MIDI System On is therefore doing something the user cannot be offered the chance to refuse, and the mode change it causes is one the instrument warns will make material recorded in the other mode play back wrongly.

Both messages are also written into Standard MIDI Files produced by the instrument, as a five-byte System Exclusive event at delta time zero.

### 11.2 Messages not recognised

A controller expecting any of the following will receive no response:

| message                        |                          |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------|
| F0 7F 7F 04 01 <i>ll mm</i> F7 | Master Volume            |
| F0 7E <i>dd</i> 06 01 F7       | Identity Request         |
| F0 7E 7F 09 03 F7              | General MIDI 2 System On |

The instrument does not implement Identity Reply, so it cannot be auto-detected by a controller that relies on it. The entire Universal Real Time identifier 7F is unrecognised.

### 11.3 Practical consequences

**A General MIDI message sent during a bulk dump breaks the dump.** While a transfer is open the instrument accepts only messages beginning F0 50. One beginning F0 7E is treated as a reception failure: the transfer is abandoned and ERROR 41 is reported. General MIDI mode is left unchanged.

**The instrument announces its own changes.** Entering or leaving General MIDI mode makes it transmit the matching message, for a change made at the front panel as well as one made by loading a song. Neither direction is affected by the EXCLUSIVE filter.

The announcement stops for good once you send one

The interlock that stops the instrument echoing a General MIDI message back is armed by the first such message it receives after power-on, and is never disarmed. Once a controller has sent either message, the instrument stops announcing its own General MIDI changes for the rest of the session. A controller that tracks the instrument's mode by listening for these messages will silently stop being told.

**General MIDI state travels in a dump.** It is carried in the second SYSTEM, PART & MIDI block, so restoring that category restores the General MIDI setting with it. A dump taken in General MIDI mode is not the same file as one taken out of it.

## 11.4 The identifier is checked once

Once 50 or 7E has been accepted the instrument does not look at it again; the third byte alone selects the message. F0 50 7F 09 01 F7 is therefore acted on as General MIDI System On despite carrying the Matsushita identifier, and a Technics message sent with 7E in the identifier position works equally well. Send the conventional identifier, but expect a receiver to be lenient.

Nothing else about General MIDI mode changes the System Exclusive implementation: every family is accepted exactly as before, with the same encoding, checksum, handshake and error reporting.

## Chapter 12

# Settings that affect System Exclusive

### 12.1 The EXCLUSIVE filter

The MIDI menu's INPUT & OUTPUT FILTER page has eight rows, each a plain ON/OFF switch for one kind of MIDI message: PROGRAM CHANGE, BANK SELECT, PITCH BEND, CONTROL CHANGE, RESET ALL CNT., CHANNEL PRESSURE, SONG SELECT and, last, EXCLUSIVE. There is one such switch and it governs both directions: the same setting is consulted when the instrument sends and when it receives. There is no separate input filter, no per-socket filter and no third state, and the page is the same on both models.

#### EXCLUSIVE governs the tempo message and nothing else

Despite its name, this switch does not turn System Exclusive on and off. Its entire effect on the messages in this reference is the family 25 tempo message: with EXCLUSIVE set to OFF the instrument neither sends one nor acts on one received, silently in both directions.

**A bulk dump transfers normally with EXCLUSIVE set to OFF.** Software that cannot complete a transfer should not look here for the cause.

This is worth knowing before telling a user to change the setting: the illustration of that page in Technics' own guide shows EXCLUSIVE switched OFF, so an instrument presenting that page as pictured is already able to send and receive every message in this reference.

Everything below is unaffected by the setting:

| function                                                 | affected by EXCLUSIVE? |
|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| bulk dump, sent or received                              | no                     |
| dump requests                                            | no                     |
| the opening enquiry and its reply                        | no                     |
| acknowledgements and the session control messages        | no                     |
| parameter messages, and the replies and refusals to them | no                     |
| General MIDI System On / Off, sent or received           | no                     |
| error reporting                                          | no                     |
| tempo message (family 25)                                | yes                    |

## 12.2 Which sockets carry what

The instrument has two sets of MIDI sockets. Only bulk-dump traffic is restricted to the first.

| message                                                          | accepted on       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| bulk-dump data, continuation frames, handshake, acknowledgements | MIDI 1 only       |
| dump requests                                                    | MIDI 1 only       |
| parameter messages (families 2B, 2C)                             | MIDI 1 and MIDI 2 |
| tempo message (family 25)                                        | MIDI 1 and MIDI 2 |
| General MIDI System On / Off                                     | MIDI 1 and MIDI 2 |

MIDI channels are written with the socket set first: 1-01 to 1-16 and 2-01 to 2-16. No channel or device-number setting affects System Exclusive addressing — these messages carry no channel.

## 12.3 Memory protect

Two write-protect switches are consulted before an incoming message is acted on. A message they block never reaches the transfer machinery, and the instrument shows its own write-protection prompt rather than a System Exclusive error. A transfer that stops with that prompt on screen has not failed as a transfer.

# Chapter 13

## Errors

Transfer failures are reported on the SYSEX BULK DUMP screen. A System Exclusive message arriving while any other screen is displayed produces no visible error.

### 13.1 The messages

| screen     | meaning                                         |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| COMPLETED! | the transfer finished                           |
| ERROR 40!  | the message is addressed to a different product |
| ERROR 41!  | reception failed                                |
| ERROR 42!  | transmission failed                             |
| ERROR 21!  | the destination is full                         |

Not every failure is a 40, 41 or 42

When incoming data is larger than the destination area, the instrument reports ERROR 21! MEMORY FULL. Software that recognises only the three documented System Exclusive errors will mis-read a truncated restore as something else.

### 13.2 ERROR 40 — wrong identification

Raised when CMD is accepted but the bytes that follow it do not match the product. For a message addressed to the SX-WSA1R that means PC was not 04, or MD was neither 00 nor 01, or VER was not 11.

### 13.3 ERROR 41 — reception

The general reception failure. It covers:

- a message inside a session that does not begin F0 50;
- a status byte other than F7 arriving inside an open message;
- a framing, parity or overrun error on the MIDI input, or loss of active sensing;
- no reply within the reply window, including the acknowledgement that each data message must receive;

- a message longer than 254 bytes;
- an odd number of payload bytes;
- a continuation flag that is neither 00 nor 01;
- a checksum mismatch.

## 13.4 ERROR 42 — transmission

Raised when an outgoing transfer stalls inside the instrument: the send path waits for one block to be handed over internally, and reports ERROR 42 when that wait times out after about a second. In version 2.0 this is its only cause.

### ERROR 42 is not a report about the receiving device

The published manual describes ERROR 42 as an error during transmission, with the data not having been received correctly. That is not what the instrument tests. The condition it reports is internal to the sending machine and can arise with nothing connected to the MIDI output at all.

A genuine failure at the far end looks different. No acknowledgement within the reply window, a framing, parity or overrun error on the input, and a transfer abandoned after its three retries all raise ERROR 41. Software diagnosing a failed transfer should read ERROR 41, not ERROR 42, as the sign of a problem on the cable or at the receiver.

## 13.5 Interference from other traffic

While a bulk-dump session is open, unrelated System Exclusive traffic arriving on the MIDI input can set the error state, and will then be reported when the session ends. Keep other sources off the MIDI 1 input for the duration of a transfer.

## Chapter 14

# SX-WSA1 and SX-WSA1R

The SX-WSA1 keyboard and the SX-WSA1R rack module ship **the same ROMs** — not merely the same program built twice, but the same images — and speak the same System Exclusive protocol. Two features are nonetheless available on the keyboard and not on the rack, in both directions, and the two models put different bytes in the model triple. Nothing else in the System Exclusive implementation depends on which model it is: the framing, the checksum, the handshake, the error reporting, the parameter address space and every other bulk-dump category are identical.

|                                      | SX-WSA1<br>(keyboard) | SX-WSA1R<br>(rack) |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|
| message framing, checksum, handshake | yes                   | yes                |
| SOUND bulk dump                      | yes                   | yes                |
| COMBINATION bulk dump                | yes                   | yes                |
| SYSTEM, PART & MIDI bulk dump        | yes                   | yes                |
| dump requests                        | yes                   | yes                |
| General MIDI On / Off                | yes                   | yes                |
| MD transmitted                       | 00                    | 01                 |
| MD accepted                          | both                  | both               |
| SEQUENCER bulk dump                  | yes                   | <b>no</b>          |
| tempo message (family 25)            | yes                   | <b>no</b>          |

### On the rack, a SEQUENCER dump sends nothing and says nothing

The rack's SYSEX BULK DUMP menu has no SEQUENCER row: it is not drawn, and the soft key that would select it does nothing. The category can still be reached over MIDI, by a dump request addressed to 60 00 00, and as part of TOTAL KEYBOARD. In both cases nothing is transmitted — not even the end-of-category message that closes every other transfer. A librarian waiting for data will simply time out.

On the rack the transfer-progress screen likewise lists only SYS,PART&MIDI, SOUND and COMBINATION.

Technics' own guide points the same way: the photograph it prints of the SYSEX BULK DUMP menu, the one showing all five rows, is captioned (WSA1) — the marker the guide uses throughout for what belongs to the keyboard.

The tempo message is refused in both directions on the rack: it will neither act on one received nor send one.

### Telling the two apart over MIDI

MD in anything the instrument transmits is 00 on the keyboard and 01 on the rack — the values Technics’ published field table gives for the two models. An identity enquiry (F0 50 21 04 00 11 F7 or F0 50 22 04 00 11 F7) is answered with the model’s own value, whichever value the enquiry itself carried. A second, behavioural test is to request a SEQUENCER dump and see whether anything arrives.

### Which machine is which

Because the ROMs are identical, the difference between the two models is not a firmware difference at all. Both behaviours are present in every machine, and a hardware input read once at power-on selects between them; the program names neither model. The identification does not depend on that, because Technics published the answer: the field table gives MD = 00 for the SX-WSA1 and 01 for the SX-WSA1R, and the machine that reads the second value is the one that transmits 01.

The same guide prints SEQUENCER : WSA1 ONLY beside the SEQUENCER row of its address map. Its user manual marks the whole sequencer chapter SEQUENCER (WSA1) and carries the same (WSA1) marker on fifty-nine further passages. A model with no sequencer has nothing to put in a SEQUENCER dump and no use for a tempo message, which is exactly the pair of System Exclusive functions that machine refuses.

# Chapter 15

## Relationship to other Technics instruments

The message engine described in this reference is not unique to the SX-WSA1R. At least two other Technics instruments implement the same protocol: the SX-KN5000 and the SX-KN1500.

### 15.1 What is shared

All three use the 50 identifier, the same message families, the same short control messages, the same payload encoding and the same checksum rule. The fixed messages are byte-for-byte identical:

```
F0 50 23 7E F7  F0 50 24 7E F7  F0 50 27 7E F7  F0 50 28 7E F7  F0 50 29 7E
                F7  F0 50 2A 7E F7
```

The error mapping is also nearly common: of the thirty-four status values, thirty-two produce the same report on the SX-WSA1R and the SX-KN5000.

### 15.2 What distinguishes the products

PC, MD and VER together are the discriminator. A message whose three bytes do not match the receiving instrument is refused with ERROR 40.

| instrument         | PC MD VER                    |
|--------------------|------------------------------|
| SX-WSA1 / SX-WSA1R | 04 00 11, 04 01 11           |
| SX-KN5000          | 01 28 12                     |
| SX-KN1500          | 01 24 11, 01 25 11, 01 26 11 |

The split is legible once the fields are named: PC = 04 is the WSA product category and 01 the keyboards, MD separates models within a category, and VER is the exclusive specification's own version — 2.1 for the WSA1 and the KN1500, 2.2 for the KN5000.

A librarian that supports more than one of these instruments needs only to vary those bytes and the dump region addresses; the framing, handshake, encoding and checksum are common code.

### 15.3 Dump regions differ

The dump region addresses are per-product. The SX-KN5000 and SX-KN1500 share eleven of their thirteen region and length pairs with each other, but the SX-WSA1R shares none of its eight with either — its categories are its own.

#### A fourth instrument's name sits in the signature table

The program holds its block signatures as literals, and immediately after WSA SOUND RAM S0 — its own — comes KN3000 SOUND RAM. No pointer in either program image reaches that second string, so nothing here shows it being used, and whether this instrument would accept an SX-KN3000 sound block is not established. The coverage of that negative is three-byte little-endian pointers across both 512 KB images; the string could still be reached by indexing from the first.

#### The SX-WSA1R does not accept the GS-style messages its siblings do

The SX-KN5000 and SX-KN1500 additionally accept a small set of messages in the 42 12 parameter form, including the sequence 42 12 40 00 7F 00 41 used elsewhere in the industry as a reset. **The SX-WSA1R accepts none of them.** Software that resets a KN-series instrument that way and assumes the SX-WSA1R will follow will find it does not respond.

## Chapter 16

# Worked examples

Three things in this format are easy to get subtly wrong: the seven-bit address encoding, the high-nibble-first payload, and which bytes the checksum covers. The examples below are complete messages, and every byte in them is computed rather than transcribed.

### 16.1 A parameter, written and read back

The example is part 0's parameter 03, a one-byte value, set to 100.

|            | message                                                        |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| write      | F0 50 2C 04 00 11 00 20 03 00 00 01 06 04 00 41 F7             |
| request    | F0 50 2B 04 00 11 00 20 03 00 00 01 00 4C F7                   |
| reply      | F0 50 2C 04 00 11 00 20 03 00 00 01 06 04 00 41 F7             |
| part 7     | F0 50 2C 04 00 11 00 27 03 00 00 01 06 04 00 3A F7             |
| three-byte | F0 50 2C 04 00 11 00 20 00 00 00 03 01 02 00 00 04 00 00 45 F7 |

The value 100 is 64, which DT carries as the two bytes 06 04. The three bytes before it are SIZ, and the 00 after it is CN. SM closes the message.

### 16.2 A frame from a real instrument

The bytes below open the first data message of a dump recorded from an SX-WSA1R, a transfer of three categories in one session:

F0 50 2D 04 01 11 40 00 00 00 00 20 ...

Reading it by the rules of chapter 5: CMD is 2D BTR; 04 01 11 are PC, MD and VER, the middle one being the rack's; then ADR 40 00 00 and SIZ 00 00 20, which together name block 1 of SYSTEM, PART & MIDI. The length decodes to 32 source bytes and the frame carries 32 of them.

The payload decodes to 5A 5A 01 00 57 41 30 00..., the signature section 6.1 gives for that block.

That block is the one chapter 7 maps: a dump of this category can be read against table 7.1 directly, which is the cheapest way to confirm a parameter address without an instrument to hand.

# Chapter 17

## Scope of this edition

This reference covers message framing, the bulk-dump transfer protocol, the parameter address space, the sound and drum areas, the effects, the universal messages, error reporting, the differences between the two models, and the layout of the SOUND and COMBINATION blocks a dump carries.

### 17.1 Deliberately outside it

**What a parameter does to the sound.** Chapter 7 enumerates all 108 addresses of the 00 area with their name, length, bit mask, accepted values and position in a dump, and chapter 8 does the same for the sound areas. What a setting *does* is the user manuals' subject, not a protocol reference's.

**The effect block diagrams.** The guide draws the signal path of each of the 56 effects. Chapter 9 gives their parameters instead.

### 17.2 Open, and what would close it

**What three inert bytes are for.** The combination stream is decoded in section 6.4, and chapter 7 names most of what its records hold; the effect records are named by chapter 9 instead. What was left over has been read across the whole stored corpus — 385 combinations of eight parts, so 3080 part records, from three sources produced independently of one another: the 129 presets carried in the program, 128 from a user's flash dump, and 128 more from the combination area of a native disk file.

*Reserved.* Block A holds the same value in all 3080 records at +02, +04, +10 and +15–+1A, and block B does at +00–+02, +0D, +11, +12 and +15. Every one reads zero. Write zero there.

*Named.* The last three bytes of each block are a second PROGRAM CHANGE & BANK for that part: +1B and +1C are one 7-bit number split four bits and three, and +1D is a bank drawn from the same values the part's own bank uses. Of the 890 parts carrying a non-zero one, the number and the bank *both* match the part's own in 296, and the number never matches without the bank matching too — against a control, the same test run against a neighbouring part, that lands 39 times. The pair +1B, +1C takes **exactly 128 distinct values** across the corpus, which is what a 7-bit number split four and three must and which no rival reading of those two bytes predicts. The shape is confirmed from outside the dump as well: the instrument's re-map files are sixteen groups of eight, the same 4+3 split, holding entries that are exactly (number, source)

pairs. A second copy of an address that usually differs from the first is an indirection, which is also why the triple is not a function of the program number.

The program agrees. These bytes are never named by an address — a part record is reached through a pointer, which is why earlier searches for their addresses found nothing — but they are named by displacement off that pointer, and those are short distinctive byte strings. There are three sites that write all three bytes and three that read all three, in both images, and **not one site anywhere touches any of the three on its own**: they are a single field. At the writing site the values come back from a conversion whose input is written to a fixed address as *two* bytes and whose result is read from another as *three*, with an inverse beside it that takes three and returns two. A three-byte form of a two-byte quantity is exactly what a program number and a bank become.

*Inert.* Block B's +18+1A take fifteen distinct combinations across the corpus and read 01 01 01 or 00 01 01 in four records out of five. Nothing names them, and both halves of that have now been measured rather than assumed.

From the data: over all 3 080 part records and 220 byte columns, none of the three is a copy of any other column, the three together are not a copy of any other three-byte run, and no column determines any of them — the best dependency is 0.62 of the target's entropy where a shuffled control scores 0.03 and a determination would score 1. The closest match, +1A agreeing with +03 in 97.6 % of records, is two nearly-constant columns agreeing and nothing more.

From the program: a part record is reached through a pointer, so these bytes are named by displacement, and there are two displacements they could carry — block B sits 20 past block A. At the first, no group of instructions touches all three, in either image. At the second there are five, and not one of them reaches a part record; two are inside a 64-entry uniform table that the reference disassembler refuses to decode as instructions at all. The test for “does this reach a part record” is the step that turns a table index into a part slot, and it is controlled: it fires on the sites that write the triple next door, and on none of these five.

So these three bytes are carried in stored data and copied wholesale, and no code treats them as fields. For a librarian that is actionable — preserve them, do not compute them. What remains open is only what they are *for*, and since no code on this processor reads them the answer is not in this program; the obvious place to look next is the second processor.

Also open: which side of the indirection the triple holds — what the part asked for, or what it resolved to. Eight of the nine re-maps in the corpus are identity maps, so the two sides coincide wherever it could be checked. Deciding it needs a machine with a non-identity re-map loaded, dumped.

**What the seventeenth stream carries.** Section 6.5 covers a song record's shape entirely, decodes PERFORMANCE — 256-byte blocks numbered from one, chained by a 16-bit link at +03, carrying a flat event stream whose statuses and lengths are tabulated — and establishes that entry *i* of the song header is track *i*.

Sixteen of the seventeen entries are the sixteen recording tracks Technics publishes, each naming its own part in every controller event it carries. The seventeenth names no part. What it holds is the one thing about the sequencer this reference does not say, and a recording made on a known single track would settle it along with the roles of the header's other two seventeen-entry tables.

**Operating system version 1.** Everything here describes version 2.0. Closing this needs a dump of the earlier firmware, and there is not one to be had here: the archive this project works from carries a single firmware set, whose own accompanying note calls version 2 “probably the last released version”. This is an absence of an artefact rather than a piece of analysis left undone. This version carries no sign of the earlier one: a search of all three program images turns up no conversion path and no compatibility text, and nothing compares the version byte a block carries. A reader can nonetheless establish what they are holding, two ways.

Over MIDI: VER, the sixth byte of any message that carries it, is 11 here — exclusive specification 2.1. A machine speaking a different version announces it there, so a receiver can tell at once that it is talking to something this reference does not describe.

At the instrument: it has a ROM VERSION screen of its own, which reports its ROMs separately as WSA-A, WSA-C and WSA-D.

And from the front panel, against a document rather than against the machine’s own account of itself. Technics issued a one-page erratum to the owner’s manuals, QQCG0279A, whose single change renames the second soft key of the SOUND MODE home screen from VOL to LVL and makes it adjust the level relative to the current value, −30 to +30. The firmware read here already carries the new caption, so it is later than that erratum. The rename reached one screen only: the image holds four soft-key rows of that shape, and the two whose last key is MIDI — the screen the erratum photographs — read LVL, while the two whose last key is PART still read VOL. An instrument whose SOUND MODE home screen says VOL is older than the machine this reference describes.